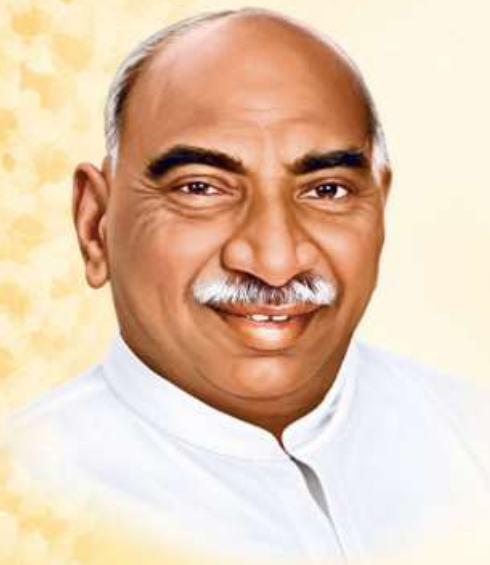




Expansion of

PERUNTHALAIVAR KAMARAJAR BREAKFAST SCHEME

Inauguration by

Thiru. **C. JOSEPH VIJAY**

Hon'ble Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu



44,984

Government and
Government Aided Schools

7,537 additional schools



34.64 lakh
students

15.30 lakh additional
students in classes
6 to 8 will benefit

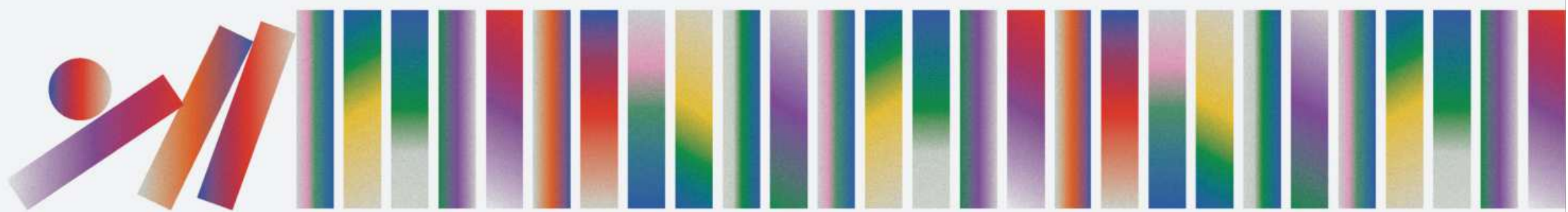


Rs.724 crore

Rs.217.63 crore
additional fund allotted

Date: 22.9.2026, Tuesday, Time: 8.30 AM

Venue: Chennai Middle School, Gandhigramam, Thiruvanmiyur, Chennai.



They are the visionaries who dream quietly and act with intent. Their steady pursuit of progress turns belief into action, and action into a future we can all look forward to.

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Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman
Honourable Minister of Finance and
Corporate Affairs, Government of India



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TERRIFIC TRIO

Shooters to the fore once again

SPORT » PAGE 13



MULTILATERAL PUSH

India to attend session by new initiative at UN

NEWS » PAGE 9

PROGRESS PATH

Arithmetic of a growth ambition

A number of factors will determine T.N.'s goal of a \$1.5 trillion economy

EDITORIAL » PAGE 6



SUO MOTU CASE

3 held for assaulting teenagers in Bihar

NEWS » PAGE 10

NEARBY



Chief Minister reviews monsoon preparedness

CHENNAI
Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Monday held a meeting at the Secretariat to review the preparations for the Northeast monsoon and the steps taken for prevention of dengue in Tamil Nadu. » PAGE 4

Stalin warns of protest over new Secretariat

CHENNAI
DMK chief M.K. Stalin has warned that his party would join hands with fishermen's organisations for a massive protest if the State government went ahead with its proposal to build a new Secretariat at Pattinapakkam. » PAGE 4

India-New Zealand FTA to come into effect on Oct. 20

Both countries ratify agreement which aims at doubling bilateral trade to ₹35,000 crore in 'next four to five years'; India's dairy, sensitive agriculture sectors protected, says Commerce Minister

Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

The Free Trade Agreement (FTA) between India and New Zealand that was ratified on Monday and comes into effect on October 20 aims at doubling bilateral trade to ₹35,000 crore in the "next four to five years", according to Union Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal.

"The entry into force of the India-New Zealand FTA will translate this goal into concrete economic outcomes," he told journalists. According to New Zealand's foreign trade office, the FTA is set to erase import levies on all Indian goods, while 95% of exports to India will either be allowed tariff-free or at "sharply" reduced levies.



They [New Zealand] could look to support our companies or invest and set up manufacturing in India to capture global markets

PIYUSH GOYAL
Union Commerce Minister



It [the FTA] gives confidence to our business communities to grow, form relationships, and trade

TODD MCCLAY
Minister of Trade and Investment, New Zealand

Mr. Goyal insisted that India has safeguarded its sensitive sectors, such as dairy and agricultural produce, including onions, almonds, chickpeas, peas, artificial honey, and sugar, not granting Wellington any relaxation or concessions on these products in

the agreement. The deal will benefit India's micro, medium, and small enterprises, farmers, handloom artisans, and weavers, the Minister added.

New Zealand also has technological expertise in manufacturing of engineering and other goods,

Mr. Goyal said. "They could look to support our companies or invest and set up manufacturing in India to capture global markets," he added.

New Zealand's Minister of Trade and Investment, Todd McClay, emphasised the significance of the two countries getting the deal done at a time of global "uncertainty", with escalating tariffs and trade barriers. "It gives confidence to our business communities to grow, form relationships, and trade," he said.

India is New Zealand's ninth largest export market, and the value of bilateral trade between the two countries stood at \$1.3 billion in the fiscal year 2024-25.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 8

'Ram Temple SIT found 105 cases of currency removal'

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

A status report submitted by the Uttar Pradesh government's Special Investigation Team (SIT) identified 105 instances of unauthorised currency removal captured on CCTV in the Ram Temple donations misappropriation case, a Supreme Court Bench led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant noted on Monday.

Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the Uttar Pradesh government, said the probe investigation had been "substantially concluded" and a chargesheet in the case would be filed before the court of the jurisdictional Additional Sessions Judge on or before Friday.

The 90-day statutory period for investigation, which started with the first arrest in the case, would draw to an end on Friday, after which the accused persons were entitled to



The SIT, in a report submitted to the Supreme Court, has said that a chargesheet in the theft case will be filed by Friday. FILE PHOTO

default bail, the law officer pointed out.

The top court noted from the report that the role of every person allegedly involved had been assessed.

Unexplained deposits

"Some of the accused have been identified along with details provided on the number of times they engaged in misappropriation... The status report details the analysis of CCTV footage and other materials to identify the eight accused persons. It also presents a tabulated sum-

mary of the unexplained deposits in their accounts and information about the immovable and movable assets where the stolen money was invested," the top court order recorded.

The status report has recorded the estimated amount misappropriated by each accused individual and noted that existing evidence suggested that the suspected misappropriation took place within the counting room during the handling of the currency.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 8

3 civilians killed in Pak. attacks: Taliban

Agence France-Presse
PATAN (AFGHANISTAN)

At least three civilians were killed in Pakistani attacks in eastern Afghanistan, the Taliban authorities said on Monday, while Islamabad said its forces targeted "terrorist hubs" along the border.

Pakistan's Information Ministry said 28 militants were killed in the "intelligence-driven ground operation". The Taliban government, which rejected the claim, condemned the attacks and warned of "appropriate response".

The Taliban's Foreign Ministry summoned Pakistan's chargé d'affaires in Kabul and lodged a formal protest about the attack.

The Taliban's deputy

spokesperson, Hamdullah Fitrat, said Nurgal district came under attack at around 3 a.m. on Monday. The strike "completely destroyed" a house, killing three and wounding four members of the same family, he said.

AFP journalists saw a house reduced to rubble in the village of Patan, where dozens of men gathered for the funerals of the victims of Pakistan's first deadly cross-border strikes since June. The UN mission in Afghanistan, UNAMA, said it had "confirmed at least three civilians, a man, a woman, and a girl, were killed and four injured in apparent air strikes" in Kunar, the province where Patan is located. (With inputs from AP)

Homeward trek



Unknown land: Mahouts on elephants guide a greater one-horned rhinoceros that wandered out of the Pobitora Wildlife Sanctuary in search of food, in Morigaon district of Assam on Monday. PTI

IIT-Bombay removes Professor from post of Dean amid protests

Chinmay Gaikwad
MUMBAI

The Indian Institute of Technology-Bombay removed Suryanarayana Doolla from the post of Dean (Administrative Affairs) with immediate effect on Monday, following protests by students over the death of Sahil Wakode, a 20-year-old B.Tech. student, an official communication said.

The decision was conveyed to students in an email by IIT-Bombay Director Shireesh Kedare. "We apologise for the statements contained in our earlier communication concerning the circumstances surrounding the unfortunate demise of Sahil. The details and circumstances leading up to the incident remain subject to investigation by the appropriate authorities. The Deanship of Prof. Suryanarayana Doolla is suspended with immediate effect. Any further action will be taken after investigation," the email said.

Students continued their protest on Monday, saying Professor Doolla's suspension from an administrative position alone was not enough and that he must be suspended as Professor too. The institute did not issue a separate statement on the suspension.

Professor Doolla was named in the first information report (FIR) registered by the Mumbai Police on the basis of a complaint by Wakode's parents. The complaint alleged that Professor Doolla subjected their son to caste-based discrimination.

Wakode, a second-year B.Tech. student from Mah-



Demonstrators at IIT-Bombay pay tribute to the deceased student on Monday. PTI

arashtra's Yavatmal district, was found dead in his hostel room on Friday in a case of suspected suicide. The administration, in its initial communication, referred to the student's alleged use of an AI platform during an examination invigilated by Professor Doolla. This prompted a protest from the students, who argued that proceedings before the disciplinary action committee should have remained confidential until a conclusion was reached.

The suspension of Professor Doolla was among 18 demands submitted by the protesting students to the institute administration on Sunday. The charter was handed over to Professor Kedare during his meeting with the students at the institute's main gate late on Sunday. The talks lasted nearly three hours. Professor Kedare signed the charter and assured students that the institute would work towards fulfilling their demands.

Earlier on Monday, the IIT-Bombay issued an apology for statements made in its earlier communication regarding Wakode's death, meeting another demand of the protesting students.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 8

Starbucks to establish Global Capability Centre in Chennai

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu government has clinched another deal in the Global Capability Centre (GCC) arena, inking a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with Starbucks, which will establish its GCC in Chennai.

An official release said the MoU was signed on Monday in the presence of Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, Minister for Industries, Investment Promotion and Commerce S. Keerthana, Industries Secretary S. Vijayakumar, and Guidance CEO and Managing Director Deepak Jacob. Guidance is the nodal agency for bringing in investment. The project is expected



Building capability: The MoU was signed in the presence of Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, Minister for Industries S. Keerthana, and senior officials. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

to create 800 high-value jobs in its first phase.

Sources, who were part of this deal, said the Industries Minister had sent a communication to Starbucks to facilitate this deal.

Ms. Keerthana said, "We are delighted to welcome Starbucks to Tamil Nadu. A global brand of Starbucks'

stature choosing Chennai to establish its Global Capability Centre is a strong endorsement of our talent, our capabilities, and the business environment we are building in Tamil Nadu."

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 4

Govt. hospitals short on critical medicines for pre-term babies

Serena Josephine M.
CHENNAI

Government hospitals across Tamil Nadu are facing a shortage of critical and life-saving surfactant medicines for pre-term babies.

The shortage has been persisting for the past few months, and several Special Newborn Care Units (SNCUs) at government hospitals have been flagging it up for the Health Department.

Doctors said surfactant medicines are essential to inflate the lungs of pre-term babies in need of the therapy. They utilised external bovine or porcine surfactants (intra-tracheal) in pre-term babies. These

Surfactant medicines are essential to inflate the lungs of pre-term babies in need of the therapy

surfactants were part of the speciality drug rate contract purchases of the Tamil Nadu Medical Services Corporation (TNMSC).

Inquiries with a number of hospitals and doctors revealed that a number of centres were facing short supply of surfactants in the past few months. Official sources confirmed that government hospitals, among them medical college hospitals in Theni, Dharmapuri, Tiruppur, Cuddalore, Tiruvannam-

lai, Vellore and Karur districts and in Chennai, reported surfactant vial shortage, while some hospitals said they had uninterrupted supply.

A doctor said the shortage prevailed in the past three to four months owing to a number of factors. "First, we got no allotment. Secondly, some centres miscalculated their requirement, which is based on the average number of pre-term babies delivered, and thirdly, there was higher utilisation. This is a life-saving medicine essential to inflate the lungs of pre-term babies who are otherwise solid," he said.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 4

INBRIEF



M. SRINATH

Private hospital launches first responder bike ambulances

Kauvery Hospital on Monday launched “Kauvery First Responders”, a network of bike ambulances across Chennai. According to a press release, 10 bike ambulances have been deployed across the hospital’s Chennai network, covering Alwarpet, Vadapalani, Radial Road, and Maa Kauvery locations, in the first phase. Each first responder bike is equipped with essential emergency response equipment, including an Automated External Defibrillator, oxygen support, and an emergency medical kit. P. Pakalavan, Joint Commissioner of Police (Traffic - South), Chennai, flagged off the vehicles. Manivannan Selvaraj, founder and managing director, Kauvery Group of Hospitals, said that the “Kauvery First Responders” was designed to put trained medical responders and essential emergency equipment on the road, enabling appropriate care to begin at the scene while ambulance and hospital teams coordinate the next stage.

ECO WATCH

Geetha Srimathi
CHENNAI

Scores of Vinayaka idols, which were worshipped over the past week, were found broken and washed ashore along the city’s beaches a day after the immersion on Sunday, leaving sanitation workers to clear tonnes of debris.

According to data from the Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC), 92.965 tonnes of waste were collected from the immersion sites between September 19 and September 20.

They included 9,413 idols, 61,690 kg of wooden pallets, 8,010 kg of flowers, 20,365 kg of dry waste,



Tidying up: Corporation workers cleaning the Pattinapakkam beach after the idol immersion. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

1,550 kg of wet waste, and 1,350 kg of food waste.

Palavakkam accounted for the highest quantity of waste at 77.2 tonnes, including 57.1 tonnes of wooden pallets and 704 idols. At Srinivasapuram in Pattinapakkam, 4,879 idols were collected, the highest

among the locations listed by the GCC.

Despite an advisory from the Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board on eco-friendly idols, the city witnessed a huge amount of large idols made of Plaster of Paris (PoP).

A sanitation worker at

Pattinapakkam, who did not wish to be named, said they had been redirected to beach-cleaning duties on Monday, and had been clearing the debris since morning.

“It is a bit sad to see the idol that was worshipped a week ago become trash,” the worker said.

M.S. Swaminathan Research Foundation scientist R. Ramasubramanian said the materials used in the idols and decorations could take days to dissolve. While the sea would disperse them over a wider area, immersion in smaller waterbodies could have a more concentrated impact, he said.

“Even in the sea, the immersion of idols made of PoP adds to existing pollution. The paint, which con-

tains harmful chemicals such as lead and other heavy metals, can disturb the coastal ecosystem,” he said.

Marine biologist and trustee of Nizhal T.D. Babu said idols were traditionally made of clay, particularly as the festival coincided with the period before the monsoon, when lakes and rivers were desilted.

The clay from the desilting process was traditionally used by potters, he said, and returned to the periphery of the waterbodies to strengthen the bund and avoid water seepage during the monsoon.

However, the use of PoP and the trend of installing increasingly large idols for community celebrations had changed the practice over the past two decades,

Mr. Babu further said.

“There must be a system in place; the government must bring out an SOP for the idols and the immersion process. There should be regulations at every stage, from the making of idols to community pandals,” he said.

Mr. Babu suggested a door-to-door collection of clay idols, which, he said, could reduce dumping, the need for large police deployments, and traffic congestion around immersion points. The dimensions and other specifications of community idols should also be declared in advance, he said.

“Vinayaka, who is believed to remove obstacles, should not be made an obstacle to environmental well-being,” he said.

City police widen probe in case against Veeramani

R. Sivaraman
CHENNAI

The Greater Chennai Police has widened its probe in the POCSD case against Gem Granites chairman R. Veeramani to examine alleged financial transactions involving police officers, political functionaries, and people in media houses, who are said to have been linked to the granite baron.

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay summoned Greater Chennai Police Commissioner A. Amalraj and directed

CM summons City Police Commissioner A. Amalraj and directs him to take action against those who allegedly suppressed or delayed the case

him to take action against those found responsible for allegedly suppressing or delaying the case. The conversation lasted about two minutes, during which the Commissioner briefed him on the developments. Ho-

wever, the allegations regarding the suppression of the case have not yet been established.

Sources said Mr. Vijay instructed the Commissioner to ensure that no one involved in the case was let off and directed officials to expedite the investigation and make it watertight.

The Chief Minister also sought frequent updates on the probe, and directed the police to ensure the protection of survivors and handle the case with sensitivity.

Additional Commissioner

of Police (South) Narenthiran Nayar has been tasked with leading the team probing the financial transactions of Veeramani.

Sources said the accused owns substantial assets in India and abroad, and that the investigators have detected heavy financial transactions during the intervening period. The probe is examining allegations of money transfers involving police officers, influential media personalities, and political leaders.

A property on the East Coast Road was allegedly

sold by the accused for ₹90 crore through the son of a prominent trade union leader. The transaction is also under investigation, sources said.

Another team headed by the Additional Commissioner of Police, Central Crime Branch, P.C. Thenmozhi, and Deputy Commissioner of Police V.V. Geethanjali is probing the alleged sexual offences.

Sources said the police were likely to seek custodial interrogation of Veeramani and his associate.

One killed as truck collides with bus near Chengalpattu

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A 45-year-old driver of a truck was killed and 17 others, including passengers of a State Transport Corporation bus, were injured when the truck carrying M-sand collided with the bus

near Chengalpattu on Monday.

A senior police official of the Chengalpattu district said the bus, carrying 40 passengers, was proceeding on GST Road, towards Kilambakkam, when the truck driver lost control of his vehicle and collided

with the bus near Palaveli. The front portion of the truck and the bus were damaged.

The truck driver, Anand, a resident of Kattur village in Thirukazhukundram, died on the spot. The injured included the bus driver, Surya.

Minister files ₹1-cr. defamation case against YouTuber

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

The Madras High Court on Monday granted leave to Minister for Natural Resources T.K. Prabhu to sue YouTuber M. Maridhas for having allegedly made defamatory statements against him on YouTube, X, and other social media platforms.

Justice K. Govindarajan Thilakavadi allowed an application filed by the Minister, seeking the leave of the court, and directed the High Court Registry to number the defamation suit filed by him against the YouTuber, Google LLC, YouTube India, and X Corporation based in California.

The orders were passed after the court heard senior counsel P.H. Arvinth Pandian, assisted by Vikram Veerasamy, who contended that a part of the cause of action for filing the civil suit had arisen within the jurisdiction of the High Court, and hence, the Minister was entitled to file the suit there.

G. Palanithurai appointed Adviser to Minister Anand

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Veteran academician and expert in panchayat raj G. Palanithurai has been appointed adviser to Rural Development-Panchayat Raj and Water Resources Minister N. Anand.

Apart from providing “professional advice” to the Minister in matters concerning panchayat raj and rural development, he will guide the government with regard to capacity building in village panchayats.

Prof. Palanithurai, formerly with the Gandhigram Rural Institute, Dindigul, has been attached to the State Institute of Rural Development for administrative reasons.

He will draw an honorarium of ₹1 lakh per month, according to a government order issued early this month.

BUSINESS CONNECT

A Business Initiative

Chennai Ports’ Pig Iron Export Record



Chennai Port recently achieved an all-time record in pig iron export handling by moving 14,778 tonnes in a single day. The cargo was handled through m.v. Supra Monarch at Jawahar Dock-VI, surpassing the previous record of 13,208 tonnes from m.v. Agia Charis. Chennai Port Authority Chairperson Sachin S. Kurve, IAS, congratulated the stakeholders for their coordination and teamwork. The milestone was achieved through the efforts of vessel agent James Mackintosh Co. Pvt. Ltd., stevedore Shippascaargo and exporter SLR Metaliks Ltd.

Vasanth & Co wins Best Dealer Award



Voltaas held its dealer meet in Tokyo, Japan, where Chennai-based Vasanth & Co was honoured with the Best Dealer Award, recognising it as India’s No. 1 dealer. Accepting the invitation, Mrs. Tamilselvi Vasanthakumar, Managing Partner, and Mrs. Thangamalar Jaganath, Working Partner, Vasanth & Co, attended the event in Japan. The award was jointly presented by Voltaas representatives Mr. Jayant Balan, Head – UPBG; Mr. Jogesh Jaitley, Head – Sales; Mr. Srinivass Raju, Sales Head – South & West; and Mr. M.V. Praveen, RBH – South. The recognition highlights Vasanth & Co’s strong performance and continued association with Voltaas.

BoB wins Rajbhasha award



Bank of Baroda (BoB) has received the Second Prize under the Government of India’s Rajbhasha Kirti Puraskar Scheme for 2025-26, recognising its Official Language implementation. The award, presented on Hindi Diwas 2026 and the Sixth All India Official Language Conference in Navi Mumbai, marked the fifth consecutive year the bank has been recognised, with three First Prizes and two Second Prizes. Receiving the award, Managing Director and CEO Debadatta Chand said its multilingual banking initiatives span digital and physical channels, including bob World, WhatsApp Banking, chatbots and call centres, with its AI-powered bob-SAMVAD tool supporting engagement in Indian languages. Overall, the bank received 20 awards, including recognition for the Ayodhya committee and 18 NARAKAS Protsahan Samman awards.

SASTRA’s 40th Convocation Day



India’s growth story offers immense opportunities, with its young workforce making it a global investment destination, said R. Shankar Raman, President and Whole-time Director-Finance, Larsen

& Toubro, at SASTRA Deemed University’s 40th convocation in Thanjavur. He identified healthcare, education, public transport and utilities, semiconductors, water, defence, and energy and environment as key investment areas. He called for stronger industry-academia collaboration and continuous learning, saying, “While the first degree is for the first job, continuous learning is for the last job.” A total of 4,414 students received UG, PG and Ph.D. degrees. Three scholars won Best Ph.D. Thesis Awards, while Biyyappu Hari Keerthi received two academic excellence awards.

DAC launches Balmandaissa in Porur



DAC Developers launched BALMANDAISA, an ultra-luxury residential project on Porur-Poonamallee Main Road. The launch was attended by Founder and Managing Director Sathish Kumar Santhanam, Mudhal Partners Founder and CEO and Zoho Co-Founder Kumar Vembu, Aditya Birla Housing Finance’s Hari Vignesh R and Manjunath Selvamani, and landowner Kumarasekaran. Located within walking distance of a metro station, the project comprises 194 residences, including 2 and 3 BHK apartments and 4 and 5 BHK duplexes with private terraces. Its 10,000-sq-ft clubhouse, The Meridian, offers 40+ amenities. The project features two basements built using diaphragm wall technology, still and 13 residential floors. Homes start at Rs. 1.19 crore. DAC has completed 150+ projects, with a presence in Sivaganga, Coimbatore, Dubai and Singapore.

Sowbaghya Coco’s Expert Scraping



Making everyday kitchen prep easier, the Sowbaghya Coco is a 2-in-1 electric appliance that combines coconut scraping with knife sharpening. Its 100W motor offers two speed settings – 270 rpm and 180 rpm – while Vacu-Sil suction technology keeps the appliance stable

during use. Designed with safety in mind, it features a press-switch, anti-tilt No-Move Grip and auto shut-off to prevent overheating. The appliance comes with food-grade stainless steel, rounded-edge blades for efficient and safer scraping. Operating on 220-240V AC, it has a 1.5-metre cord and a 15-minute ON/30-minute OFF rating. Available in red, green and orange, the Sowbaghya Coco brings two useful kitchen functions together in one compact appliance.

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PERSONAL	PERSONAL
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FURNITURE I, RAMKUMAR s/o Thiyaagarajan AGE-39 DL NO-TN1020050013763, residing at 145,dhanalakshmi street,janakani nagar, valasaravakkam, chennai-87 have changed name "RAM KUMAR T" to "Ramkumar" as per notary affidavit dated 20-09-2026	HEALTH HAPPY FOOT Reflexology. @ Shenoy Nagar. 60min- 999/- Ct: 90421 82826
HOME NEEDS I, Abinesh Govindasamy, S/o Govindasamy, R/o D.No. 3/1643, Vellalanor Village, Natrampalli Taluk, Tirupattur Dist., Tamil Nadu, declare that my mother's name is incorrectly recorded as AMUDHA in my Passport. Her correct name is AMUTHA. Affidavit No. FY 990254 dated 17/09/2026 sworn before Notary K. Mathialagan, Hosur.	BATHROOM RENOVATION From Professional Bathroom Makers Since 2001 FRIENDLY SERVICES Call Now: 044 - 2432 3144 98412-95033 98412-78121 T.Nagar, Chennai - 600 017.

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INBRIEF



12 Korean universities participate in education fair

Twelve Korean universities participated in the first ever ‘Study in Korea Education Fair’ organised by the Consulate General of the Republic of Korea in Chennai in collaboration with The National Institute for International Education. Over 1,000 students interacted with representatives of the universities, which included Kangwon National University, Konkuk University Glocal Campus, Kyungdong University Global, Dongguk University, Chonnam National University, and Busan Health University, a press release stated. The students received one-on-one consultations, insights into academic programmes, admission processes, and campus life in Korea. The fair was inaugurated by Higher Education Minister P. Viswanathan in the presence of Consul General of the Republic of Korea in Chennai Hye Ran Chun.

3 godowns for non-containerised cargo completed at Chennai Port

The port has already leased out the space, and it is currently being used to store rice and steel coils. Work is under way on the fourth warehouse. Chennai Port Authority started building these godowns at a cost of ₹73.91 crore in November 2024

PORT CALL

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

In what could help cargo handling capacity, efficiency, and increase revenue, the Chennai Port Authority has finally completed three of the export-import (EXIM) godowns. The port has already leased out this space, and it is currently being used to store rice and steel coils. This comes at a time when the port has been placing increased focus on non-containerised cargo such as food grains, agricultural products, and other commodities.



Timely addition: The opening of the godowns comes at a time when the Chennai Port has been placing increased focus on non-containerised cargo. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

The authority had taken up the work to build four EXIM godowns at a cost of ₹73.91 crore – which are covered warehouses for storing sensitive cargo – in

November 2024, and the godowns were slated for completion early this year. While three of these godowns have been built already, the last one is nearly

finished and will be ready soon.

Sources said the delay occurred due to the West Asia crisis this year. “The supply of roofing materials and fuel were affected by the West Asia conflict. This was accepted by the Ministry as well. Now, the work has been completed on three godowns, and they are being used,” a source said.

Chennai Port Authority officials said the godowns were built over a total area of 18,000 sq.m, with each one spread over 4,500 sq.m. The main reason behind establishing this infrastructure is to create safe storage for cargo such as food grains, agricultural

products and other commodities that require clean and covered spaces for storage, so that they are not affected by weather conditions.

Officials said that while rice and steel coils were now being stored, in the coming weeks, they expected to see other cargo to reach the port. It is also to be noted that these types of non-containerised cargo inflow has been slowly increasing at the port after the launch of the Non-Containerised Cargo Incentive Scheme (NCCS) three months ago, which aims to incentivise firms to import and export such types of cargo by offering them concessions.

Timings			
CHENNAI			
TUESDAY, SEP. 22			
RISE	05:58	SET	18:05
MOON	15:09	SET	02:02
WEDNESDAY, SEP. 23			
RISE	05:58	SET	18:05
MOON	15:50	SET	02:53
THURSDAY, SEP. 24			
RISE	05:58	SET	18:04
MOON	16:28	SET	03:44

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	34	24
Chennai Airport	36	26
Chennai City	37	27

Chennai Airport Today
36°C The weather will be very warm and uneasy. Night will be comfortable. Spell of light to moderate rain and thunder-shower to occur.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
35°C Morning will be comfortable. Day will be warm. Night will be comfortable. Spell of moderate rain and thunder-shower to occur.

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THE HINDU
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MMA wins national-level award for 16th time

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Madras Management Association (MMA) has been conferred the Best Management Association in India Award for 2025-26 by All India Management Association's (AIMA), marking the 16th consecutive year that it has received the national honour.

The award comes during MMA's Platinum Jubilee celebrations and marks another milestone in its seven-decade history of promoting management education and professional



MMA executive director R. Vijayakumar said the award reflected the association's focus on management education, professional excellence, thought leadership, and lifelong learning.

development. MMA president A.R. Unnikrishnan said the consecutive recognition was a testimony to the association's sustained leadership and

contribution to the management movement in India.

MMA executive director R. Vijayakumar said the award reflected the asso-

ciation's focus on management education, professional excellence, thought leadership and lifelong learning.

The award was presented by Amitabh Kant, former G20 Sherpa and former CEO of NITI Aayog, at the inaugural session of AIMA's Platinum Jubilee National Management Convention at Hotel Taj Palace in New Delhi on Sunday.

The award was received on behalf of MMA by Immediate ex-president Lakshminarayanan Duraiswamy, president A.R. Unnikrishnan, and executive director R. Vijayakumar.

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu's Energy Resources Minister C.T.R. Nirmal Kumar launched the Tamil Nadu Rooftop Solar Subsidy Scheme in Chennai on Monday, to encourage domestic consumers to install rooftop solar plants.

The Minister said that Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay had announced a special additional subsidy for rooftop solar plants, in the Assembly, and had allocated ₹50 crore for this purpose in the current financial year.

Consumers who had ap-



Energy Resources Minister C.T.R. Nirmal Kumar said the subsidy scheme has set a target of installing rooftop solar plants in one lakh households by March next year. R. RAGU

plied from August 5 would be eligible to receive the combined Central and State government subsidy of ₹35,000 for 1 kilo watt

(kW), ₹70,000 for 2 kW, and ₹1,00,000 for 3 kW, he said. The Minister said the subsidy scheme set a target to install rooftop solar

plants in one lakh households by March next year. The Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation limited (TNPDC) also launched a portal <https://www.tnebtld.gov.in/ursr/> to apply.

The website would provide all the information regarding the residential rooftop solar scheme, including details on subsidies from both the Central and the State government, guidelines for installation, application procedures, application status, a list of authorised solar vendors, and other relevant information.

WESTERN RAILWAY - AHMEDABAD (SURVEY & CONSTRUCTION)
CORRIGENDUM NO.1 TO TENDER NOTICE

Tender No.: CAO-C-ADI-PGMS-WR-01. Name of Work: Request for Proposal (RFP) for: Providing Project General Management Services for New Line, Multitracking, Gauge Conversion, Electrification and other important works etc. in Construction Organization under CAO/C/ADI of Western Railway, for a period of 60 months. The following change has been made in the Tender Notice of the above-mentioned E-Tender, which was scheduled to be opened on 07-10-2026, which is now to be opened on 14-10-2026.

S.N.	Item	Existing	To be read
1	Bid Due date	07-10-2026 at 15:00 Hrs.	14-10-2026 at 15:00 Hrs

This will form a part of tender document. All other terms & Conditions shall remain unchanged. No.ADI/III/PGMS/Corr./01 Dated: 21-09-2026 CPM 072

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e-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tenders are invited from eligible tenderers online through <https://tntenders.gov.in> for the following item under "Two part System"

e-tender Ref. No	Name of the Item	Total Quantity (in Nos.)
83/2026	Portable Diagnostic Ultrasound Scanners (Veterinary Use)	143
84/2026	Reflective Dog Collars	
	Red Collars	1,20,000
	Green Collars	1,20,000
	Implantable RFID Microchips with application syringe	2,40,000
	Microchip readers	100
	Supply / Development , deployment , maintenance of dedicated software for management and monitoring of the program and support for a period of three years	1

Pre-Bid Meeting on 29.09.2026, 11.30 a.m., Individual tender documents with full details can be downloaded at free of cost, from <https://tntenders.gov.in> from 23.09.2026 upto 23.10.2026, 10.00 am. Last date for submission of tenders: 23.10.2026, 11.00 am Corrigendum/Addendum to this publication, if any, would appear only on the above website. DIPR/2910/TENDER/2026 Chief Executive Officer

भवन निर्माण विभाग
बापू टावर, पटना
बापू टावर फेलोशिप

बापू टावर फेलोशिप की संस्थापना महात्मा गांधी द्वारा बिहार में किये गये सामाजिक, राजनीतिक एवं आर्थिक कार्यों का अध्ययन एवं शोध करने के उद्देश्य से, बापू टावर समिति (भवन निर्माण विभाग, बिहार के अन्तर्गत गठित सोसाइटी) के द्वारा की गयी है। बापू टावर फेलोशिप के लिए निम्न सूचनाओं के आधार पर योग्य अभ्यर्थियों से आवेदन पत्र आमंत्रित किए जाते हैं।

फेलोशिप:— फेलोशिप के तहत प्रत्येक फेलो को एक वर्ष के लिए महात्मा गाँधी और बिहार के रिश्ते, बिहार में महात्मा गाँधी द्वारा किये गये कार्य / दर्शन अथवा ऐसे वृहत्तर विषय जो महात्मा गाँधी और बिहार के रिश्ते को व्यंजित करते हैं, पर शोध कार्य करना होगा। शोध कार्य को फेलोशिप वर्ष के अंतिम माह में समाप्त करना होगा।

फेलोशिप की संख्या:— 05 (पाँच)

एक फेलोशिप की राशि:— 5,00,000 /— (पाँच लाख रुपये मात्र)

योग्यता:— गांधी आधारित विषयों में स्नातक या उच्चतर डिग्री।

अथवा

महात्मा गाँधी एवं उनके जीवन दर्शन से जुड़े क्षेत्र में 05 वर्ष से अधिक कार्य करने का अनुभव।

अनुभव:— उच्चतर डिग्री / महात्मा गाँधी एवं उनके जीवन दर्शन से जुड़े क्षेत्र में पाँच वर्ष से अधिक कार्य करने के अनुभव रखने वाले अभ्यर्थियों को प्राथमिकता दी जाएगी।

अधिकतम आय सीमा:— 50 वर्ष (आवेदन की अंतिम तारीख से गणना की जाएगी)।

आवेदन की प्रक्रिया:— अभ्यर्थियों को अपने बायोडाटा के साथ आवेदन एवं फेलोशिप के दौरान किये जाने वाले शोध कार्य के लिए 4000–5000 शब्दों में शोध प्रस्ताव तीन प्रतियों में देना होगा और अनुभव संबंधी साक्ष्य (यदि हो तो) भी संलग्न करना होगा। किसी कार्यालय / संस्थान में पूर्णकालिक तौर पर कार्य कर रहे अभ्यर्थी को अपने कार्यालय / संस्थान से अनापत्ति प्रमाण पत्र निश्चित रूप से समाहित करना होगा अन्यथा उनके आवेदन पर विचार नहीं किया जाएगा। अन्य अभ्यर्थी जो किसी कार्यालय / संस्थान से जुड़े नहीं हैं, वे अपना आवेदन इस माध्यम-पत्र के साथ देंगे कि वे किसी भी कार्यालय / संस्थान में पूर्णकालिक रूप से कार्यरत नहीं हैं। अभ्यर्थी अपना आवेदन, बायोडाटा, अनुभव प्रमाण-पत्र (यदि हो तो), फोटो एवं शोध प्रस्ताव के साथ स्वीड पोस्ट अथवा कूरियर अथवा हाथों-हाथ के माध्यम से आवेदन करेंगे।

- आवेदन पत्र (सभी वांछित दस्तावेजों के साथ) भेजने का पता:— निदेशक, बापू टावर, गर्दनीबाग, पटना-800001
- आवेदन, विज्ञापन प्रकाशन की तिथि से बापू टावर कार्यालय में स्वीड पोस्ट / कूरियर अथवा हाथों हाथ प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि 15 अक्टूबर, 2026 है। 15 अक्टूबर, 2026 के बाद प्राप्त आवेदनों पर विचार नहीं किया जाएगा।

उक्त सूचना www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर भी देखी जा सकती है।

PR. No. 012083 (BCD) 2026-27

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Sl. No	Online Tender no with qty./ Document Cost	Sale Period	Pre bid	Submission	Opening
1	E1577/HPLC/NHM/TNMSC/ENGG/2026, dt:17.09.2026- Hemoglobin HPLC Variant System(1) and HPLC System for Screening of New-Borns for Hemoglobinopathies(1) -Rs.5,725/-	22.09.2026 to 28.09.2026	25.09.2026 11.00 AM	29.09.2026 11.00 AM	29.09.2026 12.00 Noon
2	E1578/ANL/RC/TNMSC/ENGG/2026, dt:15.09.2026- Semi Auto Analyzer (1037) -Rs.5,725/-	23.09.2026 to 22.10.2026	01.10.2026 11.00 AM	23.10.2026 11.00 AM	23.10.2026 12.00 Noon
3	E1579/MON/RC/TNMSC/ENGG/2026, dt:15.09.2026- Twin Transfer Trolley (4), High end Multichannel Patient Monitor with Hemodynamic Auto-triggered NIBP (82) & High end Multichannel Patient Monitor (5) -Rs.5,725/-	23.09.2026 to 07.10.2026	28.09.2026 11.00 AM	08.10.2026 11.00 AM	08.10.2026 12.00 Noon
4	E1580/DEFIB/RC/TNMSC/ENGG/2026, dt:15.09.2026- Biphasic Defibrillator (50) -Rs.5,725/-	23.09.2026 to 07.10.2026	28.09.2026 11.30 AM	08.10.2026 11.00 AM	08.10.2026 12.00 Noon
5	E1581/FUR/RC/TNMSC/ENGG/2026, dt:15.09.2026- Twin Transfer Trolley (26), Examination Couch (2729), Bedside Locker (1844) & Baby Trolley (125) -Rs.5,725/-	24.09.2026 to 08.10.2026	29.09.2026 11.00 AM	09.10.2026 11.00 AM	09.10.2026 12.00 Noon
6	E1582/COT/RC/TNMSC/ENGG/2026, dt:15.09.2026- Stainless Steel Top Cot (506) & ICU Cot (679) -Rs.5,725/-	24.09.2026 to 08.10.2026	29.09.2026 11.30 AM	09.10.2026 11.00 AM	09.10.2026 12.00 Noon
7	E1583/EYE/RC/TNMSC/ENGG/2026, dt:15.09.2026- Schiotz Tonometer (25) -Rs.5,725/-	24.09.2026 to 08.10.2026	29.09.2026 12.00 Noon	09.10.2026 11.00 AM	09.10.2026 12.00 Noon
8	E1584/IMO/DME/KIPM/TNMSC/ENGG/2026, dt:15.09.2026- Multistage tender for Establishment of Invitro medical Device Testing Facility including Biocompatibility Testing System in Dept. of Biological Control at KIP&M -Rs.5,725/-	24.09.2026 to 08.10.2026	29.09.2026 12.30 PM	09.10.2026 11.00 AM	09.10.2026 12.00 Noon

For details visit www.tntenders.gov.in and TNMSC website www.tnmsc.tn.gov.in

DIPR / 2908 / TENDER / 2026 GENERAL MANAGER (EQUIPMENT)

National Highways Authority of India
(Ministry of Road Transport and Highways)

नवी सूचना/RECRUITMENT NOTICE

भारतीय राष्ट्रीय राजमार्ग प्राधिकरण (भा.रा.प्र.ा.) प्रतिनिधित्व आधार पर निम्नलिखित पद के लिए नवी हेतु आवेदन आमंत्रित करता है:-
National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) invites applications for recruitment to the following post on Deputation basis:-

Post	No. of posts*	Pay Scale
महाप्रबंधक (भूमि अधिग्रहण एवं संपदा प्रबंधन) General Manager (Land Acquisition & Estate Management)	01	से मैट्रियस में लेवल-13 (रु. 123100-215900) Level-13 in Pay Matrix (Rs. 123100-215900)

*पदों की संख्या भा.रा.प्र.ा. की आवश्यकता के अनुसार बढ़ाई या घटाई जा सकती है।
*Number of posts may increase or decrease as per requirement of NHAI.
2. भा.रा.प्र.ा. की वेबसाइट (<https://www.nhai.gov.in>) पर उपलब्ध विस्तृत विज्ञापन में दी गई प्रक्रिया के अनुसार आवेदन दिनांक **21.10.2026 (सारे 06:00 बजे तक)** अंतिम आवेदन जमा करना सुनिश्चित करें।
The applicant is required to ensure submission of online application as per the procedure indicated in the detailed advertisement, available on NHAI website (<https://www.nhai.gov.in>), by **21.10.2026 (upto 06:00 PM)**.
3. आयु सीमा, योग्यता मानक, अन्य शर्तों आदि से संबंधित विस्तृत विवरण भा.रा.प्र.ा. की वेबसाइट पर देखे जा सकते हैं।
Details regarding age limit, eligibility criteria, other conditions, etc. may be accessed on NHAI website.
4. इस विज्ञापन के संबंध में शुद्धिपत्र/अनुशेष/निरस्तीकरण, यदि कोई होगा तो, उसे केवल भा.रा. प्र.ा. की वेबसाइट पर प्रकाशित किया जाएगा।
Corrigendum/Addendum/Cancellation to this advertisement, if any, shall be published on NHAI website only.

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AI Tools & Chat GPT

Course Duration 2 Days (ONLINE) Date: 26 & 27 Sept. 2026 Time : 5:00 PM to 8:30 PM

Course Content: Introduction to AI Tools for Marketing, Modern prompting technique (R-C-O-F), Generative engine optimization basics for your website, Social Media Poster Creation, Product Photograph Generation, Ad Copywriting, Email Series Creation, Ad Video Generation, Content Creation Automation, Presentation Creation, Infographic Creation, Ad Targeting, Market Research, Competitor Research, Digital Marketing Strategy, Content Planner Creation, Tools Covered: ChatGPT, Canva AI, Gemini AI, Napkin AI, Copypai, AIPRM for ChatGPT

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REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL THROUGH E-TENDER
(RFP Notice No. RLDA/RFP/CT-13 of 2026 Dated 15.09.2026)

“CONSULTANCY SERVICES FOR FEASIBILITY STUDY, DETAILED MASTER PLANNING, URBAN DESIGNING, ENGINEERING & PREPARATION OF DETAILED PROJECT REPORT (DPR) AND PROVIDING ALL OTHER DOCUMENTS REQUIRED FOR MAJOR UPGRADEATION OF DR. MGR CENTRAL RAILWAY STATION (CHENNAI CENTRAL) SOUTHERN RAILWAY.”

Name of Work	Bid Document Fee	Bid Security/EMD	Estimated Cost
Major upgradation of Dr. MGR Central Railway Station (Chennai Central), Southern Railway.	Rs. 3,540/- (i.e. GST@18%) (Non-refundable)	Rs. 64,600/-	Rs. 32,30,300/-

Last date of downloading of e-bid Document for participation/submission online : 05.10.2026 up to 23:59 Hrs. (Any details to be obtained from Joint General Manager/Project/Bangalore)
Last Date of Submission of e-bid Online: 06.10.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs.

For further details of the project, please visit our website <https://rlda.indianrailways.gov.in> or on e-procurement portal <https://www.tenderwizard.in/RLDA> under the heading 'tender/e-tender'
For any clarifications, may please contact :-

CPM/Bangalore	JGM/Project/Bangalore	DGM/Expert/Chennai	For e-bid queries
M: 9741604203 cpmbangalore@rlda.railnet.gov.in	M: 9959187887 jgmsbc@rlda.railnet.gov.in	M: 7299911141 venkks25@outlook.com	Mr. Mayank Singh (CEL) M: 8800115628 mayank.s@tenderwizard.com

Note:- Any Corrigendum or Addendum will be published only on above mentioned websites. JGM/Tender/Expert (M): 9711305031

From Page One

Govt. hospitals short on drugs for pre-term babies

A doctor at another hospital said continuous supply was not assured, and shortage occurred frequently.

A senior paediatrician said that after 34 weeks of gestation, the foetal lungs are generally mature enough to support exchange of oxygen and carbon dioxide after birth. “However, in very pre-term babies, the alveoli, which are the tiny air sacs in the lungs, may not be sufficiently mature to function effectively on their own. Surfactant, a substance produced in the lungs, helps keep the alveoli open. But in babies born very prematurely, not enough surfactant may be produced, making it difficult for them to maintain adequate oxygen levels. Depending on the baby’s condition, doctors may use respiratory support such as CPAP or a mechanical ventilator. Surfactant is delivered directly into the lungs through the endotracheal tube to prevent hyaline membrane disease.”

Lung maturity in a newborn is critical as decreased oxygen could cause hypoxia and conditions such as retinopathy of prematurity and hypoxic-ischemic encephalopathy, he said.

A Health Department source denied that there was any shortage. “Some centres may have miscalculated their requirement, resulting in shortage, or may have utilised more vials. In such circumstances, they have obtained the required supply from neighbouring facilities. A six-month purchase order, worth nearly ₹9 crore, has been issued. Additionally, operational costs are provided,” he said.

Starbucks signs MoU to set up GCC in Chennai

“We will continue to engage closely with investors and do everything possible to facilitate their growth in the State,” she added.

In a post on X, she said, “We just brewed something strong. From rich filter kaapi to Starbucks, Tamil Nadu’s story is going global.”

Tamil Nadu hosts over 450 GCCs, representing approximately 10%-15% of India’s entire GCC ecosystem, making it the third largest GCC hub after Karnataka and Telangana.

State explains to CWMA the rationale behind its demand for clearing 16 tmc ft backlog

It says the demand is based on the principle of pro-rata share in the flows realised. The Cauvery tribunal and the SC had referred to the concept of pro-rata for adoption in times of distress

T. Ramakrishnan
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu has reiterated to the Cauvery Water Management Authority (CWMA) that its demand for clearing a backlog of around 16 tmc ft in Cauvery water realisation is based on the principle of pro-rata share in the flows realised.

The concept of pro-rata assumes importance in the light of the Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal and the Supreme Court having referred to it for adoption in times of distress.

In its communication to the CWMA and the Cauvery Water Regulation Committee (CWRC), the State had mentioned that “its demand is not based on predicted future flows. Tamil Nadu is seeking only its pro-rata share in the flows actually realised up to the date of recovering, during the distress period, together with the backlog already accumulated”.

After sending the communication, the State filed an application in the Supreme Court, too, last week, seeking a direction to Karnataka to make good the shortfall in the realisation of Cauvery water from June 1 to September 9. The

Inflow shortfall

Cumulative Cauvery flows realised at Biligundlu*

Month (at the end)	Cumulatively worked out quota (tmc ft)	Pro-rata factor (%)	Flows due to T.N. as per pro-rata (tmc ft)	Actually received (tmc ft)	Backlog (tmc ft)
July	40.43	37.31	15.086	3.629	11.457
August	86.38	53.05	45.821	28.584	17.237
Sept. (up to 9th)	97.408	52.74	51.373	35.221	16.152

* Up to September 9, 2026 | **Note:** The Cauvery Water Management Authority’s stipulations on pro-rata sharing of water came into effect only in July, which is why June is not included in the table.



SOURCE: THE TAMIL NADU GOVERNMENT’S SUPPLEMENTARY AFFIDAVIT, FILED LAST WEEK IN THE SUPREME COURT

CWRC and the CWMA are to hold their deliberations on September 24.

Contending that its backlog, as on September 7 (the day before the last meeting of the CWRC and the CWMA), was about 16 thousand million cubic feet (tmc ft), Tamil Nadu argued that, instead of 6,000 cusecs at Biligundlu for the next 15 days, the Authority should have ordered Karnataka to ensure the realisation of about 20,370 cusecs (equiv-

alent to about 1.76 tmc ft a day) on the inter-State border. It also felt the CWMA’s failure in ensuring the release of the backlog of over 16 tmc ft as on September 23 would “seriously prejudice irrigation and affect agricultural operations [in Tamil Nadu]. This would seriously affect the interests of the farmers, their families, and the agricultural economy of the State”.

The State also pointed out that, as against the nor-

mal release of 15,000 cusecs to 18,000 cusecs per day from the Mettur dam for irrigation in the Cauvery delta of Tamil Nadu, only 12,000 cusecs was being released, and the supply had to be sustained for 45 days and “for that, around 55 to 60 TMC is required to be released. But the available storage in Mettur after reserving for drinking, evaporation and environment needs, as on September 8, was only 40 tmc ft”.

As on September 21, the storage of Mettur dam was 46.95 tmc ft. Applying the requirements for other needs, the quantity of water available for irrigation as on date was effectively 34 tmc ft. Assuming nil addition and discharge at one tmc ft a day, the current storage would last 34 days.

As for the rainfall pattern during the Northeast monsoon, the State said the monsoon, being “erratic, uneven or even deficient”, could not be “predicted with certainty at this stage”. So, “it cannot be presumed that Tamil Nadu will necessarily derive the anticipated benefit” from the monsoon. Besides, the present requirement of the State “cannot be deferred on the assumption of future rainfall”.

CM reviews monsoon preparedness, dengue prevention measures

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Monday held a meeting at the Secretariat to review the preparations for the Northeast monsoon and the steps taken for prevention of dengue in Tamil Nadu.

An official press release said the Chief Minister had directed officials to prepare a list of areas vulnerable to seawater intrusion and coastal erosion during the monsoon, and ensure that weather and storm warnings reached fishermen and rehabilitation centres. He said schools and community halls should be kept ready to accommodate people, and safe drinking water, food, and medical facilities should be made available at these centres.

Besides making arrangements to send messages through satellites, Mr. Vijay asked officials to use drones to survey roads, storm-water drains, and bridges, and take up maintenance work.

Revenue Minister K.A. Sengottaiyan presented the report of the Expert Advisory Committee that was constituted to monitor and assess the potential impact of a strong El Niño weather phenomenon.

The Chief Minister also stressed the need to intensify mosquito-control measures and ensure timely



C. Joseph Vijay

treatment of patients.

Mr. Vijay also chaired a meeting to review the preparations for the expansion of *Vettri Payanam* (free bus travel for women, previously called *Vidiyal Payanam*) on October 2, which marks Gandhi Jayanti.

An official release recalled that Mr. Vijay had announced the expansion of the scheme in a *suo motu* statement in the Assembly. Under the expanded scheme, women can travel free of cost on Express, LSS, Deluxe, Mofussil Ordinary, and Ghat Ordinary buses for a distance of up to 40 km.

A total of 12,692 buses have been brought under the scheme, which will benefit 84.32 lakh women.

The work on linking the Electronic Ticket Machines for implementing the scheme had been completed, and a trial run would be conducted on September 27, the release said.

Stalin warns of massive protest over proposed Secretariat at Pattinapakkam

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

DMK president M.K. Stalin on Monday warned that his party would join hands with fishermen’s organisations and launch a massive protest if the Tamil Nadu government remained “arrogant” and went ahead with its proposal to build a new Secretariat at Pattinapakkam, a coastal habitat, in Chennai.

In a statement, he said the TVK-led government should pay heed to the “cries of fishermen” and withdraw the order for the construction of a new Secretariat at Pattinapakkam. “Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay should announce the government’s decision, and construct houses for the fishermen in the area,” he said, after representatives of fishermen’s organisations met him and sought his support.

Mr. Stalin said the TVK



Seeking support: Representatives of fishermen’s organisations with DMK president M.K. Stalin on Monday.

government’s “unilateral decision” to construct a new Secretariat, “which would destroy the habitation and livelihood of fishermen”, was condemnable.

Several alternatives

Mr. Stalin said there were several other places where a new Secretariat could be built. “The Omandurar Government Estate, where a new Secretariat was constructed [during the Karu-

nanidhi government], is also available. If necessary, the super-speciality hospital could be shifted to another location, and the premises could be used as a Secretariat. But there are reports that the government has chosen Pattinapakkam because astrologers have advised that the Chief Minister’s office face the sea,” he said.

Mr. Stalin said destroying the livelihood of thousands of fishermen to fulfil

the desire of one individual was unacceptable. “Moreover, the area chosen by the government is surrounded by schools, and is reeling under severe traffic congestion. A new Secretariat there will cause hardship to the people,” he said.

Mr. Stalin said he thought the proposal would not materialise as the two Communist parties extending outside support to the government were opposed to it. “But it is shocking that the TVK government is stubborn in its stand,” he said.

Reacting to Minister Aadhav Arjuna’s claim that the government had ordered only the preparation of a detailed project report, and that no final decision had been taken, Mr. Stalin said it amounted to “deceiving the people”, as the government had already issued an order for building a new Secretariat.

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The ruling TVK on Monday dropped the names of leaders of its alliance parties from its list of star campaigners for the upcoming Assembly bypolls to Madurantakam and Dharapuram, hours after the DMK submitted a petition to the Election Commission (EC), objecting to it.

Earlier in the day, DMK organisation secretary R.S. Bharathi submitted a complaint to the EC, urging it to cancel the TVK’s list. The DMK said it went against the provisions of the Representation of the People Act, 1951, and the Model Code of Conduct.

The TVK had named Tamil Nadu Congress Committee (TNCC) president Manickam Tagore, Viduthalai Chiruthaigal Katchi (VCK) leader Thol. Thirumavalavan, Minister Vanni Arasu (VCK), D. Ravikumar



R.S. Bharathi

(VCK MP), senior VCK leader Sinthanai Selvan, Marumalarchi Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (MDMK) general secretary Vaiko, party MP Durai Vaiko, and Indian Union Muslim League (IUML) leader K.M. Kader Mohideen as its star campaigners.

In his complaint to Tamil Nadu Chief Electoral Officer Archana Patnaik, Mr. Bharathi said Section 77(1) of the Representation of the People Act used the expressions, ‘leaders of a

political party’ and ‘of that political party’ while providing for the exemption of their travel expenses from the election expenditure accounts of candidates. “According to these statutory provisions, a political party can designate only its own leaders and office-bearers as star campaigners. There is no provision under the law permitting a party to list leaders or office-bearers of another recognised political party as its own star campaigners,” he said.

Mr. Bharathi pointed out that, in accordance with the guidelines issued periodically by the Election Commission, a party was required to list only its own leaders to campaign for its candidates. Even in the case of alliance partners, he said, declaring a leader of one party as the official star campaigner of another party amounted to the misuse of the exemp-

tion from election expenditure.

He said recognising individuals from other parties as a party’s star campaigners created the risk of campaign expenses, including travel and accommodation, being unlawfully exempted from, instead of being debited to, the election expenditure of candidates.

“This completely undermines a level-playing field. Furthermore, I wish to emphasise here that this runs entirely contrary to the Election Commission’s foundational principle of conducting free and fair elections,” he said.

Mr. Bharathi also urged the Election Commission to issue directions to ensure that if leaders of other parties campaigned for TVK candidates, all associated expenses were fully included in the individual candidates’ election expenditure accounts.

No blanket ban on rooster fights, DGP’s office tells HC

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

The office of the Tamil Nadu DGP on Monday clarified to the Madras High Court that a circular issued by it on September 12, 2025, does not impose a blanket ban on rooster fights.

In a report filed before Justice V. Lakshminarayanan, the DGP’s office said the intent of the circular was to curb the practices of tying knives or blades around the necks of the fighter cocks, stitching their eyes, and so on.

The report was filed after the judge had asked State Public Prosecutor R.

John Sathyan to explain under what authority did the DGP instruct police officers across the State to ensure that “no incident of cockfight is allowed in their jurisdiction”.

L. Balaji Saravanan, Assistant Inspector General of Police, High Court cases monitoring cell at the office of the DGP, said the words in the 2025 circular were used in the context of preventing cruelty. He said the Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court had, in an order passed on May 21, 2024, observed that there were complaints of rooster fights being conducted for betting and gambling, though such acts were

prohibited.

The principal seat of the High Court in Chennai had, on August 13, 2025, directed the police to ensure that neither gambling nor any form of cruelty is perpetrated during rooster fights.

The DGP’s office had issued the 2025 circular only to implement the court orders, the report said.

Justice Lakshminarayanan recorded the submissions and disposed of a writ petition filed by R. Arun Kumar, who had urged the court to quash the 2025 circular and permit rooster fights during village temple festivals in Erode and Namakkal.

New dengue figures come into public domain

Serena Josephine M.
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu’s Health Department on Sunday made public dengue figures for a three-year period that had not been in the public domain until now.

The figures differ from those published by the Union Health Ministry’s National Centre for Vector Borne Diseases Control (NCVBDC), and come from a broader dataset that includes dengue cases diagnosed not only through dengue NSI antigen tests and IgM antibody tests, but also through rapid diagnostic tests.

The State Health Department’s newly released figures show 56,863 dengue cases in 2023, 46,971



The State Health Department figures are substantially higher than the corresponding figures published by NCVBDC.

in 2024, and 25,585 in 2025. These are substantially higher than the corresponding figures published by NCVBDC – 9,121, 27,378, and 23,407, respectively. But before 2026, NCVBDC figures had been cited in reports on

The newly released figures show 56,863 dengue cases in 2023, 46,971 in 2024, and 25,585 in 2025

Tamil Nadu’s dengue burden, including in studies published by the Directorate of Public Health and Preventive Medicine. The State Health Department’s higher three-year figures were publicly reported before its release on Sunday. While the two datasets differ in the number of cases reported, both have the same number of deaths – 12 in 2023, 13 in 2024, and 12 in 2025.

State health officials clarified that NCVBDC took only cases confirmed

by NSI/IgM tests, not rapid diagnostic tests, and hence the data variation. They maintained that these were the actual figures communicated by the department in the previous years, and were captured by the Integrated Disease Surveillance Programme/Integrated Health Information Platform portal.

Separate data

A reliable source explained that infectious disease measurements must factor in population size and testing availability. “The Government of India takes into account laboratory-confirmed cases by specific standardised methods, and not other rapid diagnostic tests, clinical diagnosis or platelet

drops. States with better surveillance and reporting appear to have higher case counts than those under-testing. So, the State had separate data to better understand the epidemic situation and to guide local control measures. While officially reporting laboratory-confirmed NSI/IgM test cases, the State used the remaining count through rapid test, clinical diagnosis, and platelet metrics, along with inpatient fever numbers, to effectively manage the situation,” he said.

It may be recalled that Tamil Nadu had two dengue peaks – in 2012 and 2017, recording 13,204 cases with 66 deaths, and 23,294 cases with 65 deaths, respectively.

INBRIEF



Flight to Frankfurt diverted, terminated due to smell

A direct flight from Bengaluru to Frankfurt in Germany on Sunday was diverted to Mumbai and terminated due to an unusual smell emanating from the aircraft cabin. German carrier Lufthansa, which operates the daily non-stop flight, was scheduled to depart from the Kempegowda International Airport around 3 a.m. on Sunday. However, the departure was delayed by three-and-a-half hours. On the way, the flight was diverted to Mumbai due to the smell and later terminated.

17 injured as giant honeybees swarm KSRTC bus in Keralam

Seventeen persons were injured after a swarm of giant honeybees attacked bus passengers near the tourist spot of Gavi in Pathanamthitta district on Monday. The incident occurred in the Periyar Tiger Reserve. The KSRTC bus had 58 people on board, including the crew. When it passed Gavi, the driver stopped on a narrow stretch to give way to a car. In an instant, bees surged into the bus and stung the passengers. The injured were taken to the nearby hospitals for treatment.

4 injured as armed gang goes on stabbing spree in Bengaluru

An armed gang of unidentified men went on a stabbing spree at several locations at Uttarahalli in Bengaluru on Sunday night, injuring at least four people, in seemingly unprovoked attacks. According to the police, around 9 p.m., six to seven men on motorcycles, armed with machetes, attacked four friends standing by the roadside. They then attacked bystanders near a fish stall. The police have identified four suspects and detained a few others for investigation.

SC orders fresh probe into 2012 Karnataka rape-murder

Top court tells State to constitute a tech-savvy SIT without any officer from the old investigation team and complete probe in 3 months; lone accused in case was acquitted by CBI court in 2023

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday ordered a fresh investigation into the 2012 brutal rape and murder of a 17-year-old near the bathing ghat on the outskirts of Dharmasthala in Karnataka, while expressing shock at the botched-up probe into the incident.

A fresh investigation should be concluded within a period of three months and the police report shall be filed before the court concerned, the court said on a petition from the victim's mother.

The lone accused in the case, Santosh Rao, was acquitted by a Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI)

Injustice to a person who was falsely charged can always be compensated. However, injustice to the victim who was brutally raped and then murdered can never be compensated. Society would be failing in its duty if it does not provide justice to the victim of such a heinous crime by conducting a proper investigation and bringing the real culprits to book

SUPREME COURT BENCH

court in June 2023.

“Injustice to a person who was falsely charged can always be compensated. However, injustice to the victim who was brutally raped and then murdered can never be compensated. Society would be failing in its duty if it does not provide justice to

the victim of such a heinous crime by conducting a proper investigation and bringing the real culprits to book,” a Bench of Justices Sanjay Kumar and Sanjeev Sachdeva observed.

“Investigation must be fair, transparent and judicious as it is the minimum requirement of rule of law.

Kasturirangan report on Western Ghats causing fear among farmers: Shivakumar

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar on Monday told the Legislative Assembly that the proposed implementation of the Kasturirangan Committee report could threaten the livelihoods of people in 10 districts, even as he reaffirmed the State government's commitment to protecting the livelihoods

of farmers and residents of the Western Ghats.

During the debate on the report, Mr. Shivakumar said its recommendations had created “an atmosphere of fear” among farmers. “More than six rivers originate and flow through the Western Ghats. The proposal of unscientific measures has caused widespread anxiety regarding people's livelihoods,” he said. Before attending

the session, Mr. Shivakumar had toured the coastal and Malnad regions, which would be affected by the report, and had held meetings with people.

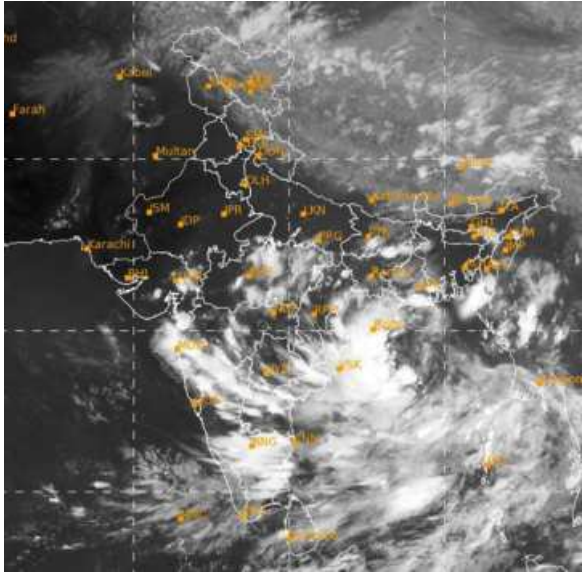
According to the Kasturirangan report, 20,668 sq. km of Karnataka's Western Ghats region has been identified as ecologically sensitive, covering 1,449 villages. Mr. Shivakumar said people and farmers had made several sugges-

tions during his consultations. “Farmers have sought rejection of the report and have demanded that a new committee be constituted. They have also urged that the Ecologically Sensitive Zone classification be scrapped and the Keralam model adopted,” he said.

The Centre has asked Karnataka to convey its decision on the report by September 27.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Tuesday: Heavy/very heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Assam, West Bengal, Odisha, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Maharashtra and Karnataka. Thunderstorm with lightning & gusty winds likely at isolated places over Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Kerala, Lakshadweep and Andaman & Nicobar Islands

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	1.....	35.8	27.0	Kurnool	7.....	33.7	26.2
Ahmedabad	26.8.....	34.7	25.0	Lucknow		35.0	26.0
Aizawl		33.4	23.7	Madurai		36.0	24.1
Bengaluru	0.6.....	31.0	20.9	Mangaluru	29.3.....	30.2	24.7
Bhopal		31.2	22.0	Mumbai		32.4	26.5
Bhubaneswar	0.2.....	29.7	25.8	Mysuru	16.3.....	33.2	20.4
Chandigarh		35.7	24.4	New Delhi		35.6	25.0
Chennai		35.2	25.5	Patna		34.0	27.2
Coimbatore		32.0	23.0	Port Blair	10.4.....	29.2	25.0
Dehradun		33.4	22.0	Prayagraj		35.0	26.8
Gangtok	7.....	24.0	16.9	Puducherry		35.2	25.0
Goa		32.4	25.8	Pune	21.....	31.6	23.9
Guwahati	2.8.....	34.5	25.2	Raipur	0.3.....	32.2	25.2
Hubballi		29.0	22.0	Ranchi		29.7	22.0
Hyderabad	3.....	32.6	22.9	Shillong		27.8	16.3
Imphal	3.9.....	31.3	20.7	Shimla		26.8	11.7
Jaipur		34.0	25.6	Srinagar		30.2	11.7
Kochi	4.8.....	27.6	25.2	Thiruvananthapuram	20.....	30.9	24.3
Kohima		28.0	18.0	Tiruchirappalli		36.7	25.0
Kolkata	0.6.....	35.5	26.2	Vijayawada	1.5.....	35.0	27.0
Kozhikode	20.....	33.0	24.6	Visakhapatnam		31.6	27.3

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing	Yesterday
CITIES	CMES
Ahmedabad	41.....26.....42.....122.....127.....
Bengaluru	18.....8.....54.....33.....103.....
Chennai	12.....18.....51.....33.....33.....
Delhi	32.....32.....38.....220.....203.....
Hyderabad	12.....16.....32.....94.....91.....
Kolkata	6.....49.....33.....41.....42.....
Lucknow	4.....23.....32.....77.....81.....
Mumbai	9.....22.....62.....51.....69.....
Pune	6.....41.....95.....56.....81.....
Visakhapatnam	20.....36.....23.....44.....83.....

Air Quality Code: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM2.5 & PM10: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

Karnataka HC constitutes SIT in KPSC case

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The Karnataka High Court on Monday ordered a court-monitored investigation – by constituting a

Special Investigation Team (SIT) headed by senior IPS officer and Director-General of Police Alok Kumar – into the alleged irregularities in the recruitment processes conducted by the

Karnataka State Public Service Commission (KPSC).

While giving 100 days for the SIT to complete the investigation and submit the final report, the court also directed it to submit

an investigation progress report every 30 days.

The court has named IPS officers Divya V. Gopinath, Anoop A. Shetty, Kushal Choksey, and Kshama Mishra as other members of the SIT.

Bolarum arms theft accused sent to 10-day police custody

Naveen Kumar
HYDERABAD

A Secunderabad court has granted the Hyderabad police 10 days' custody of retired Army Havildar U. Mallesh, accused in the theft of firearms and ammunition from the 20 Battalion, Madras Regiment, in Bolarum. His questioning will begin on Tuesday. Investigators are expected to question Mallesh about the theft, his motive and the possible involvement of others. However, he is reported to have claimed that he acted alone.

An officer from Bolarum police said various agencies involved in the investigation could also question Mallesh during the custody period. He will be questioned by the Malkajgiri police at the Bolarum police station. However, the National Investigation Agency (NIA) could also take him to its headquarters in Hyderabad for questioning, the officer said.

Officials have advised that his medical condition should be taken into consideration during the custody period and that a medical officer should be available during questioning. Mallesh was earlier shifted from Chanchalguda jail to a hospital after liver and kidney complications were detected during a routine medical examination following his remand.

The case pertains to the theft of 12 firearms and over 1,800 rounds of ammunition August 30 night. The police alleged that Mallesh broke open the Kote and removed the firearms and ammunitions. He was arrested on September 11.

THE HINDU PRESENTS SCHOOL BUZZ
A Newspaper exclusively curated for School Students

STUDENT EXCHANGE PROGRAMME

Vidhya Matric Higher Secondary School's delegation of young ambassadors, carrying dreams and curiosity in equal measure, arrived in Germany to a spellbinding welcome, receiving a resplendent musical reception from their partner school, filled with harmony, warmth and open hearts. Music spoke the universal language of friendship, culture and togetherness, marking the start of a journey of learning, bonding and beautiful cross-cultural melodies.

ANNUAL DAY CELEBRATED

Union Christian Matriculation celebrated their 46th Annual Day with enthusiasm and vibrant performances, centred around the theme “Together We Rise — Weaving Unity, Celebrating Friendships,” bringing together students, teachers and parents for an unforgettable evening. The school welcomed Shri Madhusudhanan IRAS, Deputy Financial Controller, Southern Railway, as Chief Guest, whose address encouraged students to cherish their school years. Distinguished alumnus Shri V. K. Ramkumar, MLA, Anna Nagar Constituency, returned as Guest of Honour, sharing memories and motivating students. Performances in music, dance and drama made the celebration a resounding success.

TEACHERS' DAY CELEBRATED

Zion and Alwin Group of Schools celebrated Teachers' Day with great enthusiasm, commemorating the birth anniversary of Dr. Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan, with over 1,000 teachers and staff participating. Thirty-seven teachers received the Best Teacher Award, three staff members the Best Administrator Award, three support staff the Best Service Award, and twelve teachers the Captain Suresh Memorial Award. Dr. N. Vijayan, Chairman, addressed the gathering on teachers' responsibility towards students' well-being and resilience. Dr. Priyadarshini, Paediatrics, CEO AYUSH Mythri, spoke on health concerns. The event was attended by Vice Chairman Mr. Aldous Huxley, Director Mrs. Rachel, Captain NSS Moorthy, Dean Dr. Shanthi and Academic Coordinator Mrs. Persia.

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OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

OBITUARY

S.Elamurugan
1954 - 2026
With profound grief we inform you of the sad demise of Mr.S.Elamurugan on the 20 September 2026 at Chennai
Deeply mourned by Family and Friends

REMA RAMAN
DOB : 17.04.1954 DOD : 21.09.2026
Your simplicity knew no boundaries
Your goodness knew no limits.
"You will forever live in our hearts"
R Raman,
Children, Grandchildren and Family Members.

SHRI MANDARAM RAMANUJAM
DOB : 17.04.1954 DOD : 21.09.2026
Dear UNCLE...
Your simplicity knew no boundaries
Your goodness knew no limits.
"You will forever live in our hearts"
Deeply Mourned by
Mahaveerchand -Yashodha
Ramesh-Usha ; ChanchalBai
Ravinder Kaur ; Sandeep-Vandhana
Ankit-Priya ; Aashish-Krithika
Saiyyam-Aaradhy-Mishay-Rinaya
Friends & Family

IN MEMORY OF YOUR LOVED ONES
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DONATE EYES - GIFT SIGHT

DEATH

Pushpa Nichani
Passed away on 20.09.2026
CHAUTHA - Wednesday, 23rd September 2026
Sindhu Sadhan, Egmore. Time: 4:30 PM - 5:00 PM
Tendly Remembered by
Amarlal, Sanjay, Sunil, Vandana & Ritika Nichani
Palu, Jyoti and Maya Hemdev

DEATH

Smt. RAJALAKSHMI
W/o. Late Sri. Viswanathan, Director, Simpsons
Passed away peacefully at her residence at 8:00 p.m. on 21st September 2026.
FINAL RITES will be performed at 4:00 p.m. on Tuesday, 22nd September 2026.
Residence: 2, Sai Dharma Apartments, First Floor, C.V. Raman Road, Alwarpet, Chennai - 600018.
Deeply Mourned by Children, Grandchildren, Great-Grandchildren and The Entire Family.
Ph: 98407 01449, 98407 01447 99419 92211

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

7th ANNIVERSARY

Suba Subramaniam
DOD: 22.09.2019
We miss you every moment in our lives. Your presence is alive in our hearts.
Remembered by family and friends

FATHER BISHOP EZRA SARGUNAM
2-ND MEMORIAL ANNIVERSARY
July 19, 1938 - September 22, 2024
Date: 22-09-2026
Tuesday Morning 8 am - 9am
Place: Kilpauk Christian Cemetery

The Koran and politics of purdah

Recently, Kanthapuram A.P. Aboobacker Musliar of the Samastha Kerala Jamiyyathul Ulama issued a circular directing public halls and madrasas not to permit women to share public spaces with unrelated men during religious events.

He subsequently sought to justify the restriction with the startling claim that bringing women onto public platforms would cause “great destruction.” He attributed this danger to the mixing of men and women and said that the Koran itself requires women to remain confined to their homes, and prohibits them from appearing in public.

But the Koran does not instruct women to remain confined to their homes. It is conservative clerics who have historically sought to impose such restrictions by taking out of context the instruction in verse 33:33 to “stay in your houses” and “do not display yourselves as was the display of the former times of ignorance.”

Yet the verse occurs within a passage beginning at verse 28 that is explicitly addressed to the Prophet’s wives wherein the Prophet is instructed to give them a choice: they may seek the comforts and adornments of worldly life, in which case they will be granted a gracious separation, or they may choose Allah, the Prophet and the hereafter, for which they will receive a great reward. Their position is then distinguished from that of other women before laying down a heightened standard of conduct for them. They are told to avoid overly soft speech with men, to remain in their houses, not to display themselves as women did in the



A. Faizur Rahman

Independent researcher and Secretary-General of the Islamic Forum for the Promotion of Moderate Thought. X: @FaizEngineer

The historical record does not support the idea that Islam required women to be confined to their homes or excluded from public life

pre-Islamic period, and to follow Allah and the Prophet. The passage culminates in a reference intended to keep the Prophet’s household spiritually pure.

Not about all women

As is clear, the command to “remain in your houses” is addressed only to the Prophet’s wives. To remove this instruction from its specific context and present it as a universal Koranic command requiring all Muslim women to remain at home is to extend the verse beyond the scope stated in the passage itself.

Moreover, the historical record does not support the idea that Islam required women to be confined to their homes or excluded from public life. Hazrat Khadija, the Prophet’s first wife, was a successful merchant who conducted her own commercial affairs, and the Prophet himself worked for her as a trading agent before their marriage. Even after he became the Prophet, there is no indication that he asked Khadija to abandon her public life. Obviously, the Prophet did not regard a woman’s participation in economic and social life as incompatible with Islam.

The same is true of the Prophet’s wives who lived after the revelation of Koran 33:33. Hazrat Aisha travelled with the Prophet, including on military expeditions and for the Hajj, and later became one of the most important authorities on religion in the early Muslim community. She also played a public role in the political conflict that culminated in the Battle of the Camel in 656 CE. Hazrat Umm Salama, another wife of the Prophet, was likewise consulted on public matters.

These examples make it difficult to interpret “remain in your houses” in 33:33 as a command of absolute physical confinement. Whatever restrictions it imposed on the Prophet’s wives, the historical record provides little basis for turning it into a universal prohibition against women participating in public life or sharing public spaces with men. Not surprisingly, in *Al-Muhaddithat*, the English introduction to his 43-volume Arabic compendium of Muslim women scholars, Mohammad Akram Nadwi rejects the view that Islam is “a human construct, done mainly by men and therefore done to secure advantages for them at the expense of women.”

Nonetheless, the subjugation of women cannot be challenged through reformist rhetoric alone. It requires the Muslim laity to publicly question clerical authority itself, and political leaders to stop lending legitimacy to regressive clerical institutions through high-profile visits and public engagement. The recent meeting of Malaysian PM Anwar Ibrahim with Mr. Aboobacker in Keralam illustrates the problem. Such public recognition can embolden male clerics to present patriarchal interpretations as divine commands and discourage Muslims from questioning them. The future of Islam cannot be left to those who claim a monopoly over its interpretation. If Muslims are to progress, the Koran must remain the primary point of reference, while the Prophet’s life must be taken seriously as evidence of how Koranic principles were actually lived.

Persistent antagonism towards Urdu

In June 2026, a group of approximately 10-15 men entered Bharat Chandra High School in Armoor, Nizamabad district, Telangana, and allegedly manhandled its 37-year-old Principal, Aamir Khan. The incident reportedly arose from the perception that Urdu was being taught at the school. However, Mr. Khan, an English teacher, was not responsible for teaching Urdu; the subject had been taught briefly by another teacher. The school’s management board, headed by a person of Hindu background, had decided to introduce Urdu as a second language following a request from the parents of Muslim students, who constitute approximately 25% of the school’s total strength.

This episode is particularly significant in light of a Supreme Court judgment in April 2025, which described Urdu as a fine expression of *Ganga-Jamuni Tehzeeb*. A Bench comprising Justices Sudhanshu Dhulia and Vinod Chandran observed that “language belongs to a community, to a region, to people but not a religion.” The Court upheld the use of Urdu on the signboard of a municipal council in Maharashtra and declined to interfere with the Bombay High Court’s ruling, which had found no legal prohibition under the Maharashtra Local Authorities (Official Languages) Act, 2022, against the use of Urdu.

The contrast between the constitutional-legal recognition of Urdu as a linguistic and cultural tradition and the hostility towards it highlights the contested and communal



Shaikh Mujibur Rehman

Author of ‘Shikwa-e-Hind: The Political Future of Indian Muslims’. Views are personal

The antagonism towards Urdu is rooted in the perception that it is exclusively a language for Muslims

nature of the language in today’s India.

The antagonism towards Urdu is rooted in the perception that it is exclusively a language for Muslims. The establishment of Bangladesh in 1971 around the Bengali language demonstrated that Urdu is not the language of Muslims as a whole. Moreover, Urdu has historically been spoken and cultivated by Hindus, Sikhs, and others. Rakhshanda Jalil’s edited volume, *Whose Urdu Is It Anyway?*, brings together writings by several prominent non-Muslim literary figures, including Gulzar, Ramanand Sagar, Rajinder Singh Bedi, and Kishan Chander. Their contributions demonstrate how Urdu has historically been embedded within a diverse literary and cultural tradition. A particularly revealing case is that of Rahi Masoom Raza, the author associated with the TV serial *Mahabharat*. It has recently come to light that his novel *Aadha Gaon* (Half Village), a classic of modern Hindi literature, was originally written by him in Urdu.

Not all that different

In ordinary discourse, the difference between Hindi and Urdu is not easily noticeable. According to Paul Brass, Urdu, “in its original form, was nothing more grammatically than the spoken Hindustani of north India, particularly Khari Boli of the Delhi area, with an infusion of Persian, Arabic, and Turkish vocabulary.” This shared linguistic heritage highlights the extent to which Hindi and Urdu evolved from a common linguistic base. In 1837, Persian was replaced by English and other vernacular languages in various

provinces of British India for administrative and judicial purposes. In north India, however, the vernacular language selected for official use was not Hindi, but Urdu written in the Perso-Arabic script. This linguistic policy subsequently became a source of controversy and led to the emergence of the Hindi movement.

Around this period, two publications, one by Babu Shiva Prasad and another by Madan Mohan Malviya, contributed significantly to bolstering the Hindi movement. In 1868, Babu Shiva Prasad published a memorandum on court characters, in which he highlighted the adverse effects of the use of Urdu in the North-Western Provinces and Oudh (administrative province in British India). Similarly, Madan Mohan Malviya’s *Court Character and Primary Education in the North-Western Provinces and Oudh* expressed concern over the detrimental impact of officially encouraging Urdu among a Hindu population. At the same time, pro-Urdu campaigns also emerged. Thus, the controversy increasingly moved beyond pamphlets and petitions, giving rise to various organised efforts.

In independent India, the Hindi-Urdu controversy continued to be a divisive political issue, particularly in north India. The persistence of antagonism towards Urdu is especially striking in a country where English, a language of foreign origin, continues to be widely valued and institutionalised across regions. In contrast, Urdu, despite its historical and cultural roots in the Indian subcontinent, continues to encounter hostility.

Decoding the transition to alternative fuels

While adoption of EVs has risen in the passenger vehicles category, it is mainly two-wheeler and three-wheeler categories that are adopting EVs than cars

DATA POINT

Sachin Swaraj
Gandla Sneha

August 2026 marked a notable milestone in India’s journey towards a shift from fossil-fuel run vehicles to Electric Vehicles (EVs), as the data from the Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations’ (FADA) showed that it was a period of a “historic fuel crossover”.

In the passenger vehicles category that mainly includes cars, FADA data showed that, for the first time, the share of new vehicles in the alternative fuels category (41.95%) overtook the share of petrol vehicles (40.85%). FADA’s statement said that alternative fuels included “CNG, hybrid and electric combined”.

Without doubt, India has made considerable progress in moving away from fossil fuels and adapting EVs. As **Chart 1** shows, petrol and diesel still dominate the market by a huge margin, accounting for 83.5% of all the roughly 82 lakh vehicles registered from January to March this year. But this is a sharp 11.5 percentage points drop from the same period in 2021, when petrol and diesel accounted for over 95% of all the 57 lakh vehicles registered then.

Less adoption among cars

While the chart shows the sale of EVs on a sharp increase, accounting for 10.6% of total registrations, a granular analysis of sub-categories under the alternative fuels based on data accessed from the Vahan portal showed that this was driven more by EV adoption in the two-wheeler and three-wheeler categories. When it came to cars, the growth under the alternative fuels is more pronounced in vehicles that use CNG and LPG, which are fossil fuels with significantly lower emissions, than EVs.

The two-wheeler segment which accounts for over 70% of all

the new vehicles registered in the country had shown signs that EV adoption is gaining pace.

After registering a marginal increase year-on-year, the share of EVs in two-wheelers has made a jump from 6.4% in 2025 to 9.1% in 2026 (till August) (**Chart 2**). This is also the first time the share of two-wheelers running on petrol has come down to the 90% mark. This jump in the sale of EV two-wheelers has contributed significantly to the overall share of petrol and diesel vehicles, across all categories, coming down well below the 85% mark this year.

If there is one segment that has made a rapid transition away from petrol and diesel, it is the three-wheeler category. They, however, account for only 4% of all the vehicles sold. Of the roughly 9.8 lakh three-wheelers registered till August this year, 60.5% have been EVs (**Chart 3**). The share of petrol and diesel in the registration of three-wheelers has halved from nearly 30% in 2021 to less than 15% in 2026. Interestingly, the share of three-wheelers using CNG or LPG has also come down this year.

It is in the cars segment, which accounts for the second biggest share in vehicles after two-wheelers, that the picture is more nuanced than what the shift indicates when “alternative fuels” are clubbed together. **Chart 4** shows a remarkable drop in the share of petrol and diesel cars from 86% in 2021 to 61.6% in 2026.

However, this decline is because there are more hybrid cars that run on petrol with CNG or LNG than EVs. There is certainly progress in the sale of EVs, but it is much slower when compared to vehicles using CNG or LPG. The share of hybrid EVs has remained fairly constant since 2023 at around eight per cent. The data indicates the need for further interventions through measures such as the ramping up of charging infrastructure, which can help accelerate the pace of EV adoption among cars as well.

Nuance in the mix

The data for the charts were sourced from the Vahan portal. Values for 2026 are till August. Vehicles in few other fuel categories with negligible share in total registrations are not shown in the charts. Sachin Swaraj and Gandla Sneha are interning with The Hindu’s Data team



CHART 1: The lines show the total number of vehicles registered in each fuel category while the values within brackets show the share of each fuel type in total vehicles registered. Q1 - Jan to March, Q2 - Apr to June, Q3 - July to Sep, Q4 - Oct to Nov

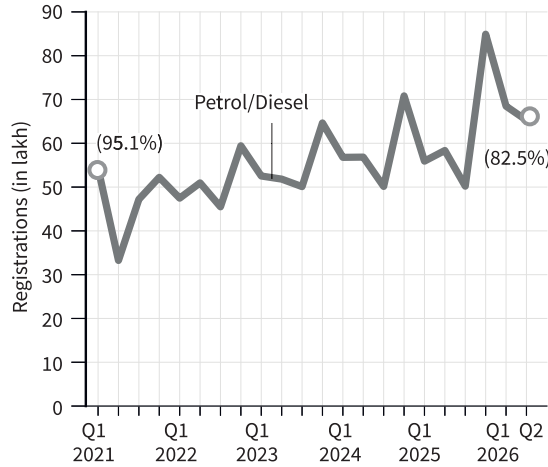
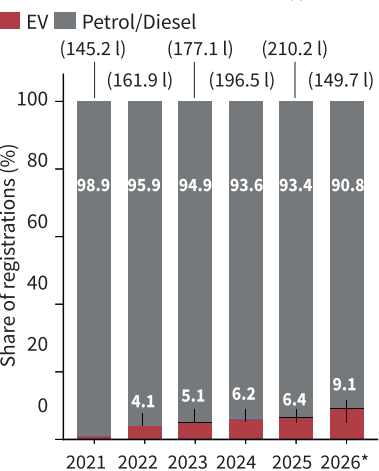
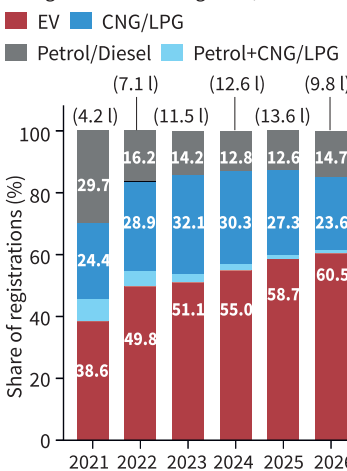


CHART 2: Share of EVs in two-wheelers has shown a notable jump in 2026. Values above bars in Charts 2, 3 and 4 show number of vehicles in lakh (l)



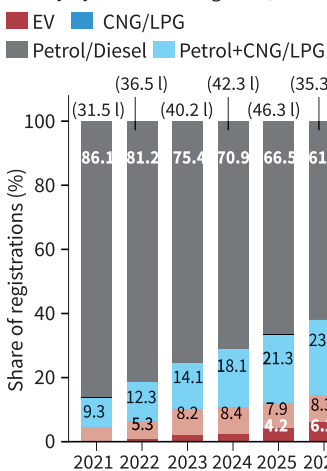
For the first time, the sale of petrol vehicles in the number of new two-wheelers registered has dropped to 90% mark in 2026

CHART 3: EVs now dominate three-wheelers, while share of vehicles using petrol/diesel have come down sharply along with those using CNG / LPG



The share of EVs among three-wheelers has jumped from less than 40% in 2021 to over 60% in 2026

CHART 4: While share of petrol and diesel vehicles in sale of cars has come down, their share is replaced mostly by vehicles using CNG / LPG



The share of petrol/diesel vehicles has come down significantly, but share of EVs is growing only marginally

FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu

FIFTY YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 22, 1976

Chavan asks passport officers to be quick, alert

New Delhi, September 21: The External Affairs Minister, Mr. Y.B. Chavan, to-day set for the passport officers in the country the twin task of being efficient and quick in the disposal of passport applications while at the same time guarding against organised activities of spurious agents and touts.

Addressing the nine Regional Passport Officers in the country, Mr. Chavan said that these might “look rather contradictory, but they are infact, not.” What was demanded of them, he said, was “awareness, alertness and vigilance combined with efficiency and courtesy.”

This was all the more so because of the increasing number of people who sought passports. Perhaps passport offices were the only instrument through which the External Affairs Ministry came in constant touch with the public and thus the working of the Ministry would be judged by the public by the way they functioned.

Unlike in the past, all categories of people, skilled and unskilled went abroad, particularly because of India’s economic co-operation with several developing countries. It should be remembered that there were certain organised agencies to commit economic offences. Passport was an important instrument for such offences across the national boundaries and this activity, he said was “quite considerable”.

It was, therefore, important for the Passport Officers, to be vigilant while at the same time being courteous to those who approached them.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 22, 1926

Hooliganism in Russia

Riga, September 21: A message from Moscow says that hooliganism is so alarming all over Russia that it is unsafe to walk after dark in less frequented streets even in Moscow and Leningrad. All classes of people in town and country are demanding that the Government should take up the matter. Many assaults on girls and other acts of violence are reported. Workmen’s clubs are forming unofficial bodies of police for self-protection.

At a meeting convened to discuss the situation, the Commissar of Interior recommended that the worst offenders should be shot as was already being done in Ukraine.

From Page One

India-New Zealand FTA to take effect on Oct. 20

Elaborating on the potential avenues for investment, Mr. Goyal said: “There are many areas where they have cutting-edge technology and innovation. Agriculture is one of their strengths in certain products.” He pointed to kiwi farming and apiculture as prime examples.

Wellington has committed \$20 billion worth of foreign direct investment into India as part of the deal.

The Commerce Minister said that global investors are interested in setting up manufacturing in India not only for access to the large Indian market but also to help “seamlessly export” to about two-thirds of the global economy where India has preferential market access.

Asked about India’s response to recent United States legislation imposing sanctions on countries buying Russian oil, Mr. Goyal said that the fine print of the law was being studied.

Responding to a query from *The Hindu* about progress on India’s trade deal with Chile, Mr. Goyal said that, following productive talks, “in the coming months, we will hear some good news.”

About the trade deal with Canada, the Union Minister noted that both sides have resolved to fast-track discussions. Indian negotiators are slated to visit the North American country for the fifth round of talks on October 5, he said.

‘SIT found 105 cases of currency removal’

According to the status report, receipts generated by the TCS software for 803 valuable articles have been verified and their relevant records have been found to be with the Temple Trust. These articles are stored in a State Bank of India locker, which was physically checked.

In so far as these articles were concerned, no discrepancies were found during the verification. However, there were 86 valuable articles in respect of which receipts have not been issued. These articles had been separately identified and physically verified.

Approximately 944.411 kg of white metal (supposed to be silver) have been sent by the Trust to Security Printing and Minting Corporation of India Limited for melting. Particular allegations regarding valuable donations reported in the media and on social media were verified. The involved individuals were interviewed and the pertinent materials were examined by them. No discrepancies were identified during this verification process.

The statements of 173 witnesses were recorded by the SIT. According to the status report, relevant standard operating procedures and records relating to the counting and handling of donations, security arrangements, CCTV recordings and reconciliation records have been examined to the extent relevant to the present investigation.

The status report was perused by the Bench in the court. However, the audio was muted and the screen went blank when the order was read out, requiring media personnel to enter the courtroom to grab shreds of the court’s oral dictation of the order.

When senior advocate Ravi Shankar Jandhyala, appearing for petitioner Ajay Kumar Rai, sought a copy of the status report, the Bench said the contents of the documents had been summarised and covered in the judicial order itself. “The State requires to be transparent,” Mr. Jandhyala said.

Noting that although it did not want to intervene in the jurisdiction of the Sessions Court, the Bench asked the State government to file a copy of the chargesheet in the top court too.

The first information report named eight people – Avinash Shukla, Anukalp Mishra, Lavkush Mishra, Manish Kumar Yadav, Karunesh Pandey, Ramashankar Mishra, Subhash Srivastava, and Ram Shankar Yadav alias Tinnu – and other unidentified individuals as accused.

IIT-Bombay removes Dean amid protests

“The details and circumstances leading up to the incident remain subject to investigation by the appropriate authorities. In view of the ongoing investigation, it was inappropriate to have set out or characterised details relating to the events preceding his demise before they had been established,” the institute said in a post on X.

A protesting student said, “Putting out an allegation against a student who is not even here to defend himself amounts to defamation.”

The charter included demands relating to institutional reforms, such as changes in faculty conduct, mental health sensitisation, counselling services, disciplinary processes and student representation.

The Faculty Association of IIT-Madras released a statement urging a fair, transparent, and time-bound inquiry into the incident, while cautioning against media trial. Meanwhile, the IIT Bombay Faculty Forum expressed solidarity with Professor Doolla, asserting he was merely discharging his academic duties in line with Senate-approved policies. However, Suryakant Waghmore, a Professor of sociology at the IIT-Bombay, posted on social media that the Faculty Forum was trying to build pressure on the investigation committee. “Not all faculty identify with this group,” he said. (For those in distress, counselling is available at Tele MANAS 14416).

Class 10 girl and boy returning from coaching groped, assaulted in Bihar

Police register *suo motu* FIR, arrest three as viral video of crime sparks political row; NCW directs support for teens, says steps should be taken to stop video circulation; Rahul Gandhi slams patriarchy; Tejashwi says Bihar put to shame by NDA govt.

Amarnath Tewary
PATNA

Two Class 10 students, a girl and a boy, returning from a coaching class were allegedly groped and assaulted by a group of men in Jamui district of Bihar on Saturday. A video of the incident went viral on social media on Monday, prodding the police to register an FIR and arrest three people.

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi and other Opposition leaders said the incident was “deeply disturbing”, indicative of the patriarchal attitudes among the supporters of the ruling BJP, and exposing the State’s law-and-order situation.

The National Commission for Women (NCW) on Monday took *suo motu* cognisance of the alleged assault and harassment, and directed the Director-General of Police to immediately register an FIR. The State Commission for Women also took *suo motu* cognisance of the incident, and promised that strict action would be taken against those found guilty.

Three arrested so far
“There was no formal complaint registered by anyone against anyone in the incident,” said Jamui Superintendent of Police Vishwajit



Dayal. “The police took *suo motu* cognisance of the incident and approached the girl and her friend, a boy. Both were returning from a hillside area after their coaching was over on the Jamui-Lakhisarai road where a group of six to seven people, some even masked, stopped them as it is shown in the viral video and they were being harassed on September 19 evening around 7 p.m.,” he added.

An FIR (No 428/ 2026) was registered over the incident at Jamui police station. All the people seen in the viral video were taken into custody and three of them have been arrested. “The police will soon arrest all of those found involved in this unfortunate incident,” Mr. Dayal said.

The NCW said, “Any compromise on the dignity, safety, and privacy of women is unacceptable at any level.” Its chairperson

Vijaya Rahatkar wrote to the Bihar DGP, directing him to immediately register an FIR over the incident. The NCW also directed that security, legal assistance, and psychological counselling be provided to the victims, and sought a detailed Action Taken Report in the matter. All necessary legal action should be taken to stop further sharing of the objectionable video being circulated on social media, it directed.

Bihar State Commission for Women Chairperson Apsara said, “I’ve spoken to the Jamui officials and they told me about the incident as it has happened on September 19 evening at 7 p.m. Stern action will be taken against all those found involved in this incident by people having a weird mindset.”

The Bihar State Commission for Women stands with all such hapless wo-

men,” Ms. Apsara added.

“The video from Jamui is deeply disturbing,” Mr. Gandhi said in a social media post. “Two class 10 students were stopped on a road. Harassed. Humiliated. Molested. A young girl’s hands folded, begged to be let go while goons groped her and dragged her away. This is not ‘culture’. It is patriarchy: the belief that any man can police a girl’s body, her movement, her choice... When control is mistaken for culture, and such attitudes are normalised by ‘Andhbhaktis’, mobs start believing they are the law,” he added.

‘Why is a girl not safe?’
Demanding prosecution of the culprits under the POC-SO Act, Mr. Gandhi, who is the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha, asked, “Who gave these men the right to behave like this? The Bihar government must answer why a girl is not safe on a public road at 7 p.m.?”

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge demanded the “harshest punishment for culprits, and accountability”. Such incidents, he said, “scream to expose the lies and hypocrisy of the BJP’s ‘Nari Shakti Vandan’ and ‘Beti Bachao’ schemes”, meant to empower women.

Rashtriya Janata Dal

leader Tejashwi Yadav, Leader of Opposition in the Bihar Legislative Assembly, also slammed the State government in a social media post.

“Bihar has been shamed by the BJP-NDA government. Everyone is ashamed. On the Jamui incident, the government’s people are making low-level statements... When the Jamui incident happened, [Bihar Chief Minister] Samrat Choudhary was holding a caste conference,” he said.

Mr. Yadav’s Singapore-based sister Rohini Acharya said: “The incident in Jamui is extremely shameful and expresses the dire state of law and order under the Samrat government, along with lax administrative influence and the stark reality of policing.” She alleged that the “sisters and daughters of the State are entirely unsafe”.

RJD leader and former MLA Shakti Singh Yadav said law and order had collapsed in the State.

State Rural Works Minister Sunil Kumar said he had spoken to the Jamui Superintendent of Police. “All those people allegedly involved into the incident would be behind bars very soon,” said Mr. Kumar. (With inputs from Sreeparna Chakrabarty in New Delhi)

Court orders fresh hearing in Sonia’s voter roll entry case

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

A Delhi court on Monday allowed a revision plea challenging a September 11, 2025 Magistrate order refusing to probe into the allegation that Congress leader Sonia Gandhi’s name was included in the electoral roll three years before she acquired Indian citizenship in 1983.

Special judge Vishal Gogne quashed the Magisterial Court’s order as “non-speaking”. The order had dismissed a complaint filed by advocate Vikas Tripathi, vice-president of the Central Delhi Court Bar Association of the Rouse Avenue courts.

“The impugned order suffers from a manifest error in law on account of non-compliance with Section 175(3) of Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), inter alia, not hearing the submissions of the

HC rejects plea over cash haul at former judge’s house

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Delhi High Court on Monday declined to entertain a petition seeking registration of FIR and probe by a Special Investigation Team (SIT) or the CBI into the alleged discovery of a large quantity of cash following a fire at the residence of former Delhi High Court judge Yashwant Varma.

Justice Amit Bansal pointed out that the petitioner, advocate Ghanshyam Upadhyay, had other remedies available under law and asked why he had not approached the trial court seeking registration of FIR. “This is a wild witch hunt. You have nothing better to do?” the court remarked.

Mr. Upadhyay submitted that the circumstances surrounding the incident were “extraordinary” and argued that the lower court could not “do justice to the matter”.

“This is regarding Justice Yashwant Varma. Criminal law can be set into motion by anyone. There is no embargo,” he said.

When the court indicated that it was inclined to dismiss the petition, Mr. Upadhyay withdrew it, stating that he would pursue the remedies available in law. The petitioner had previously moved the Supreme Court with a similar plea, which was dismissed in August.

17-year-old Naga youth shot dead in Manipur

Press Trust of India
IMPHAL

A teen was shot dead by suspected militants in Manipur’s Tamenglong district on Monday, police said.

The Naga youth, identified as N.K. Wiphenbou (17), was walking alone from Upper Nkou village to Tamei town when he was attacked around 10.30 a.m.

Naga village volunteers later found his body along a narrow path, they said.

Former Chief Minister N. Biren Singh condemned the killing and said, “Manipur cannot continue to lose innocent lives to this endless cycle of violence.”

Senior Naga leader and Naga People’s Front legislator Awangbou Newmai also condemned the killing, describing it as “cowardly” and “heinous acts of terrorism that target innocent civilians and threaten peace”.

ED files chargesheet against EaseMyTrip promoter in Mahadev betting app case

The Hindu Bureau
RAIPUR/NEW DELHI

The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has filed a chargesheet against EaseMyTrip co-founder Nishant Pitti in the money laundering case related to Mahadev online betting app, accusing him of actively assisting another co-accused in layering the proceeds of crime through stock market manipulations.

According to the charge sheet filed in a special PMLA (Prevention of Money Laundering Act) court in Raipur on September 10, Mr. Pitti, on behalf of the promoters of Easy Trip Planners Ltd., the holding company of EaseMyTrip, entered into a pre-arranged stock price manipulation deal with a man named Amardeep Sharma to artificially inflate the share price and market capitalisation of Easy Trip

The chargesheet alleges that Nishant Pitti entered into a stock price manipulation deal

Planners Ltd. The chargesheet described Mr. Sharma as an associate of Hari Shankar Tiberwal, a co-accused in the case. Earlier statements by the ED described Mr. Tiberwal as a hawala operator based in Dubai who was operating Skysexchange, an illegal betting platform.

Shares attached
Subsequent to this deal, Mr. Tiberwal’s front, foreign portfolio investor (FPI) entity AG Dynamic Funds Ltd., purchased shares of Easy Trip Planners Ltd. at inflated valuations, according to investigators.

The ED is also said to have attached Mr. Pitti’s

demat (dematerialised) shares worth ₹59.60 crore.

Meanwhile, Mr. Pitti said that he was not aware of the filing of the chargesheet and maintained that all his assets had been obtained through lawful sources of income.

“I have always cooperated with and shall continue to cooperate with all law enforcement bodies. I shall submit detailed evidence to establish my *bona fide* conduct, in accordance with the procedure prescribed by law,” Mr. Pitti said in a written response to a question for his reaction to the latest development.

“All my transactions comply with applicable laws, and all my assets have been obtained from lawful sources of income and through formal banking channels. I shall contest any insinuation to the contrary through the courts,” Mr. Pitti said.

businessline’s 8th Changemaker Awards to be given today

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The stage is set for the eighth edition of the *businessline* Changemaker Awards in New Delhi on Tuesday. The awards honour the country’s quiet architects of societal transformation.

Union Minister for Finance and Corporate Affairs Nirmala Sitharaman will be the chief guest, marking her third time anchoring the marquee event in seven years.

The milestone edition is presented by Sastra Deemed University and powered by City Union Bank. The associate partners

are State Bank of India, Life Insurance Corporation of India, Government of Andhra Pradesh, Andhra Pradesh Industrial Infrastructure Corporation, Citizen Watches, Government of Uttarakhand, Jammu & Kashmir Bank, National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development, NTPC Ltd., Indian Bank, Steel Authority of India Ltd., GAIL (India) Ltd., Essar Group, ICFAI Group, NMDC Ltd. and UCO Bank. The mobility partner is Kia Sorento.

Award selection jury
Over 1,600 nominations across five categories were received for the awards,



starting with a public call on May 12. Simultaneously, knowledge partners – Ashoka Foundation and Deloitte – and *businessline* journalists nominated potential candidates.

The submission window closed at midnight on July 7, and all entries underwent multiple screening rounds based on the selec-

tion criteria. The awards feature five categories: Social, Digital, and Financial Transformation, alongside Young Changemaker and Iconic Changemaker.

The flagship ‘Changemaker of the Year’ award honours far-reaching impact.

The *businessline* editorial team and knowledge partners select the Iconic Changemaker nominees.

The award selection jury met in Chennai on August 10.

Chaired by Justice (retired) Prabha Sridevan, the 2026 jury includes Suresh Narayanan, Safeena Husain, B. Santhanam, N.S. Nappinai, A. Balasubrama-

nian and Mukund Rajan.

Seven editions of the awards have been held since 2018, the year *The Hindu businessline* stepped into its 25th year of publishing. It could not be held in 2021 due to the pandemic.

After the nomination window closes, *businessline* and knowledge partners Deloitte and Ashoka screen and evaluate the applications. Niiti Consulting, the validation partner, then validates the shortlisted nominees before an independent jury selects the winners.

In 2025, the DRDO won Changemaker of the Year, while the Azim Premji Foundation was named

Iconic Changemaker. Araw Valley Coffee received the Financial Transformation award, and Bhashini won for Digital Transformation. Impulse NGO Network took home the Social Transformation honour. The Young Changemaker award was shared by Kalyani Shinde and the Young Tinker Foundation.

The awards for 2025 were given away by Hardeep Singh Puri, Union Minister of Petroleum and Natural Gas.

Scan the QR code to watch the award ceremony live on YouTube.



India to attend session on UN-based multilateralism

EU, Brazil, Kenya, Canada launch grouping beyond 'superpower politics'; the P4M initiative seeks a more representative UN that is prepared for global challenges, including AI and climate change

Suhasini Haidar
NEW DELHI

India will join a number of countries committed to supporting United Nations (UN)-based multilateralism, away from “Superpower” politics, as External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar was set to attend the “Partners for Multilateralism” (P4M) meeting at the United Nations.

Mr. Jaishankar landed in New York on Monday at the start of the UN General Assembly’s “High-Level debate” session. He is due to hold a number of bilateral meetings and multilateral meetings there, and will address the UNGA on September 26.

The P4M initiative, founded by leaders of the European Union, Brazil, Kenya and Canada is expected to make a pitch for the grouping this week.

In a joint editorial, leaders of the four founders said the grouping will support the UN but push for it to be more representative and prepared for global challenges, including AI (artificial intelligence), climate change, health security and digital transformation.

“P4M will support the reform of the UN and other multilateral institutions, to make them more representative, legitimate, effective and trusted,” the leaders, including European Council President Antonio Costa, Brazil President Lula da



Gearing up: Security guards checking IDs of people ahead of the United Nations General Assembly in New York. REUTERS

Silva, Kenyan President William Ruto and Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney wrote in an editorial published in the U.K.-based *Financial Times*.

Mr. Carney had delivered a speech on “Middle powers” coming together at the World Economic Forum in Davos in January, which signalled growing dissatisfaction not just with Russia and China for unilateral moves and conflicts, but with the United States over trade and tariffs, expansionist moves, and the conflict in Iran that have been undertaken during U.S. President Donald Trump’s second term.

It is unclear whether India was asked to join the joint message.

India is already part of a number of groups like the Non-Aligned Movement,

India is already part of a number of groups like BRICS and G20 that have similar objectives

BRICS, G20, and G-4 that have similar objectives.

The editorial on Monday pointed to comments by United Nations Secretary-General António Guterres in which he had said that “superpowers are discovering their limits”, adding that the P4M grouping believes that the “international community must rediscover the extraordinary potential of collective action”.

Mr. Guterres, who demits office later this year, spoke to *The Hindu* amongst five global outlets in U.S., U.K., South Africa,

the Gulf region and India.

“We have superpowers that have not yet recognised that their power has limits and they get into adventures that produce terrible results,” Mr. Guterres had said, specifically pointing to Russia, which was still embroiled in the war in Ukraine four years later, while the U.S. is facing “difficulties” with its war in Iran.

‘Limits to powers’

“I think it’s time for superpowers to understand the limits of their power, and that will help the world become more peaceful,” Mr. Guterres said, speaking to *The Hindu* in New Delhi, where he attended the 18th BRICS Summit.

The editorial also said that the ‘Partners for Multilateralism’, would not create another exclusive bloc or international bureaucracy.

“Its purpose is the opposite: to create a flexible, open framework for countries from different regions and political traditions that are willing to work across divides, to build coalitions for reform and to translate shared principles into practical action,” the co-authors wrote, pointing out that 2025 saw the highest recorded number of state-based armed conflicts since 1946, in 35 countries, and highest recorded military spending of nearly \$3 trillion.

Will try to list Mamata’s plea against EC decision to freeze symbol of Trinamool: CJ

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI



Mamata Banerjee

The Supreme Court on Monday agreed to try and list a petition filed by former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee against a decision by the Election Commission to freeze the symbol of the Trinamool Congress.

Appearing before Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, who is leading a three-judge Bench, senior advocate Kapil Sibal, representing Ms. Banerjee, made an oral mentioning that the Election Commission’s interim order freezing the symbol, even as proceedings under the Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order 1968, was unwarranted.

“The Election Commission is crossing new miles

tones every time,” Mr. Sibal submitted.

Chief Justice Kant said both sides would have arguments to make, and the court would hear all the parties. “We will try to hear it this week,” he said.

New allotment

The petition was filed hours after the poll body, on September 17, allotted new names and symbols to

the two factions of the Trinamool led by Mamata and Ritabrata Banerjee.

The Mamata faction got the name “Mamata All India Trinamool Congress” with “football player” as its symbol, while the Ritabrata grouping was allotted the name “Democratic Trinamool Congress” with the symbol “envelope”.

The plea said the EC did not comprehensively look into the party structure while considering rival claims made by the camps. The petition said the EC had banked on the statements of rebel legislators.

The Mamata camp has filed a petition highlighting the delay in the disqualification proceedings pending before the West Bengal Assembly Speaker against the 10 legislators from the rebel faction.

Congress nominee sent to judicial custody

The Hindu Bureau
KOLKATA

A West Bengal court on Monday remanded Milan Pradhan, Congress candidate for Nandigram byelection, in judicial custody for 14 days in connection with a case under the Arms Act registered in 2007.

Meanwhile, he applied for bail before the Calcutta High Court in separate cases dating back to 2007. He was arrested on September 18 in these cases and sent to judicial custody till October 3, hours after former Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee extended her support to him.

The twin court orders have, for now, effectively ended his opportunity to canvass for himself as the campaign time for the by-poll, ends on October 4. *(With PTI inputs)*

Odisha final electoral roll has 3.16 crore voters, 17.66 lakh names struck off: CEO

Satvasundar Barik
BHUBANESWAR

Odisha’s final electoral roll published on Monday has 3,16,32,754 voters, a decrease of 17,66,837 from the pre-special intensive revision (SIR) figure, according to the Office of the Chief Electoral Officer.

“The total number of voters after SIR process is 3,16,32,754 comprising 1,61,30,319 male,

1,54,99,661 female and 2,774 third gender voters,” Odisha CEO R.S. Gopalan said.

According to Mr. Gopalan, the total number of electors as on July 17 in the State was 3,33,99,591.

“A total of 3,13,87,034 enumeration forms, constituting 93.97% of the total, were received back from electors. The remaining 20,12,557 electors (6.03%) whose enumera-

tion forms were not received back were excluded from the draft electoral roll,” he said.

Those excluded from the draft roll included 8,32,544 who were found dead, 8,08,205 who had shifted out of their booths, 1,58,118 duplicate entries and 1,99,249 who were absent.

“During the claims and objections period from July 5, 2026 to August 19,

2026, a total of 2,55,996 claims and objections were received and processed for preparation of the final electoral roll. In addition, all forms received prior to July 5 were also processed for final publication. A total of 24,070 electors found ineligible for final electoral roll after hearing and 20,707 electors were deleted against the Form 7 received,” according to the CEO office.

Ansari’s remarks exposed Cong.: BJP

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Bharatiya Janata Party on Monday claimed that former Vice-President Hamid Ansari “exposed” the “Muslim League-Maoist character” of the Congress through his remarks about former Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru’s views on “Hindu right-wing communalism”.

At an event commemorating late constitutional expert A.G. Noorani on Saturday, Mr. Ansari had referred to Nehru’s view saying that “the real danger to India was not communism, but Hindu right-wing communalism”, citing Noorani’s book *The RSS: A Menace to India*.

Addressing a press conference, BJP MP and national spokesperson Sudhanshu Trivedi said the former Vice-President quoted the book, according to which Mr. Nehru said that for him communism was not as great a threat as Hindu nationalism.

‘Nehru reference’

“For this, I would like to congratulate Hamid Ansari that he has done three extremely important things. Number one, he has thoroughly exposed that the Congress has now completely become a Maoist Muslim League Congress. Secondly, he deserves congratulations for quoting that, according to Nehruji considered communism a threat. For the third point, who brought up the reference to Nehru?” he said. “It is a black chapter in the history of Independent India that five Ministers in the Kerala[m] government are from the Muslim League,” he said.

TIRUMALA TIRUPATI DEVASTHANAMS - TIRUPATI
MARKETING DEPARTMENT e-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE
e-Tenders are invited for supply of (1) 81,00,000 Kgs of Sugar (S-30) (2) 1,80,000 Kgs of Goduma Ravva (3) 90,000 Kgs of Cardamom (Elachi) 8 mm (CGEB) variety through e-tenders to the Marketing Department, T.T.Devasthanams, For Tender notice and tender details log on to the web site <http://www.tirumala.org> and <https://tender.aeprocurement.gov.in>. For further details contact phone numbers: 0877-2264079, 2264555, FAX No: 0877-2264554.
TID-40021(31)/1/2026-PRO SEC(Aad.No.187) Date:21-09-2026
EXECUTIVE OFFICER

Dr. NTR UNIVERSITY OF HEALTH SCIENCES :: A.P. :: VIJAYAWADA-8
NOTIFICATION FOR MDS ADMISSIONS 2026-27
MANAGEMENT QUOTA
Application forms through Online are invited from NEET MDS-2026 qualified candidates for admissions into Post Graduate Dental Courses respectively for filling up of Management Quota [S1, S2(NRI) & S3 (Institutional Quota)] seats in Private Un-aided Non-Minority Dental Colleges affiliated to Dr. NTR UHS in the State of Andhra Pradesh for the academic year 2026-27.

Schedule (Without a Late fee)	07.00 PM on 21-09-2026 to 10.00 PM on 24-09-2026
Schedule (With a Late fee)	08.00 AM on 25-09-2026 to 10.00 PM on 25-09-2026

Visit University Website <https://dntr.uhsap.in> for detailed Notification/ Prospectus and Regulations
Date: 21.09.2026 (Endorsement No.5148/EA2/PG/2026) Sd/- REGISTRAR

BHARAT DYNAMICS LIMITED
(A Government of India Enterprise) MINISTRY OF DEFENCE
GACHIBOWLI, HYDERABAD-500032.
Ref:BDL/CC/OT/GT/02/2026-27 Dt: 22.09.2026
e-PROCUREMENT ABRIDGED TENDER NOTICE
Inviting Indigenous Competitive Bidding

Sl.No.	Tender ID	Description	Estimate Amount in Rs.
1	67803	Horticulture & Maintenance in plant & Township at BDL Bhanur	129.15 Lakhs

Please visit website <https://bdltenders.abcpocure.com>, select online tenders on dashboard for further details. Bids should be submitted online only. "Corrigendum if any shall be issued through our e-portal only and not in Newspapers".
"Bidders are Requested to apply for online Vendor Registration in BDL website <https://bdd-india.in/registration-contractors> prospects.
DEPUTY GENERAL MANAGER (Corp Comm)

ANDHRA PRADESH POWER COORDINATION COMMITTEE
VIDYUT SOUDHA :: VIJAYAWADA
TENDER NOTICE
APPCO on behalf of the APDISCOMs inviting bids in two stage-RFQ followed by RFP through Bharat Electronic e-Tendering Portal for selection of thermal power developers towards Procurement of 1,600 MW of Thermal Power-DBFOO basis through Tariff Based Competitive Bidding("TBCB") under Section 63 of the Electricity Act, 2003.
The Interested and eligible applicants may participate in the bidding process through the Bharat Electronic e-Tendering Portal. Date & availability of RFQ document in Bharat Electronic ETS Portal is 21.09.2026 @ 23:59:00 Hrs the last date for submission of application is 05.11.2026 @ 10:00 Hrs. For complete details and tender access visit: <https://www.bharat-electronictender.com>; Ph: 9490153141.
Sd/- Chief General Manager/APPCO Power Purchase & Legal
R.O.No.GMCC/APTRANSCO/151/26-27

PUNJAB STATE WAREHOUSING CORPORATION
SCO 74-75, BANK SQUARE, SECTOR-17B CHANDIGARH
PBX: 0172-5197847, 5197846
NOTICE INVITING TENDER
PSWC invites online tenders through GeM Portal for creation of 0.45 LMT godown capacities at 03 locations in the State of Punjab for guaranteed lease of 10 years on Build, Own and Operate/Lease basis for storage requirements of FCI under two bid system "Technical Bid" and "Financial Bid".
NIT (alongwith GeM Bid IDs) is available on Department's website i.e. <https://pswc.in>
PSWC reserves the right to scrap the tender at any stage without assigning any reason and PSWC will not be held liable for any costs and consequences incurred by the intending bidders.
Note: Any corrigendum(s)/Notification(s) to this Notice Inviting E-Tender shall be published Department's website & GeM Portal.
1004/12/2026-27/15400
Managing Director, PSWC

TOURISM CORPORATION OF GUJARAT LIMITED (TCGL)
(A Government of Gujarat undertaking)
Nigam Bhavan Sector 16, Block C First Floor,
Nr. GH 4½ Bus Stand, Gandhinagar – 382 016.
Website: <https://www.gujarattourism.com>
TENDER NOTICE
The tender is invited by Tourism Corporation of Gujarat Ltd. (TCGL), for the Selection of Agency for "DEVELOPMENT OF TOURIST FACILITIES KUDA BEACH AT BHAVNAGAR". Estimate Cost of the Project **Rs.8,47,45,052.58/- + GST**. The interested bidders/agencies may download the tender document form the website: www.tender.nprocure.com from **23/09/2026** on ward Last dates of submission on online: **14/10/2026** up to 06.00 pm. Tender may also be referred on www.gujarattourism.com.
Managing Director of TCGL reserves the right to reject or accept any or all tenders without assigning any reason thereof.
Managing Director

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA - "e" PROCUREMENT NOTICE
WORKS DEPARTMENT
E-mail: ceroads.bbsr@gmail.com
Bid Identification No. CE-Roads-II-03/2026-27
1. The Chief Engineer (Roads-II), Odisha on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites percentage rate bids in double cover system through ONLINE MODE from eligible contractors for Road work as mentioned below:
2. Nature of work : Road work
3. No. of Work : 5 Nos.
4. Tender Paper cost : Rs.10,000.00
5. Class of Contractor : 'A' Class / Special Class / Super Class
6. Available of bid document in the website : From 10.00 A.M. of 30.09.2026 to 5.30 P.M. of 22.10.2026
7. Date of opening of Bid : Dt.23.10.2026 at 11.30 A.M.
8. The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website: <https://tenderodisha.gov.in>. Any addendum / corrigendum / cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said website.
Chief Engineer (Roads-II), Odisha
OFFICE OF THE ENGINEER-IN-CHIEF (CIVIL-CUM-ROADS), ODISHA, NIRMAN SOUDHA, BHUBANESWAR
34001/837/2627 OIPR-34001/34179/1/26-27/0006

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
HIGHER EDUCATION DEPARTMENT
Lokseva Bhawan, Sachivalaya Marg, Bhubaneswar-751001
PT1-HE-SCH-POLICY-0003-2026/ 50842/HE., Bhubaneswar, Dated : 21.09.2026
Corrigendum-VI
NOTICE INVITING RFP FOR PROCUREMENT, SUPPLY, INSTALLATION & COMMISSIONING OF LABORATORY EQUIPMENT & ITS ACCESSORIES FOR BERHAMPUR UNIVERSITY, GANJAM UNDER REGIONAL DIRECTORATE OF EDUCATION, BERHAMPUR APPROVED UNDER PM-USHA.
RFP No. PM-USHA : 02/2026 Date: 02.07.2026

Sl. No.	RFP CLNo.	Page No.	Description as per RFP	Modified vide Corrigendum V, dated 03.09.2026	Now Modified Provisions
1	DATA SHEET (Sl. No.7 & 8)	5	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 23/07/2026 till 4:00 PM) (Registered Post & Speed Post only)	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 03/10/2026 till 4:00 PM) (Registered Post & Speed Post only)	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 08/10/2026 till 4:00 PM) (Registered Post & Speed Post only)
2		6	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 24/07/2026 at 4:00 PM	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 29/09/2026 at 4:00 PM	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 09/10/2026 at 4:00 PM

All other terms and conditions of the RFP remain unchanged.
Joint Secretary to Govt. & SPD, RUSA/PM-USHA
11001/331/2627 OIPR-11001/11001/11/26-27/0059

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
HIGHER EDUCATION DEPARTMENT,
BHUBANESWAR
No- HE-UE-COMM-0009-2020 50704 /HE, dtd. 21.09.2026
ADVERTISEMENT FOR APPOINTMENT OF VICE-CHANCELLOR OF SAMBALPUR UNIVERSITY (SAMBALPUR, ODISHA)
Applications are invited from eligible applicants below 66 years as of 08.01.2027 (i.e. born on or after 09.01.1961) for the position of **Vice-Chancellor of Sambalpur University**. The applicant should be a distinguished academican of proven academic and administrative excellence and a well-rounded personality with a minimum of 10 years of experience as Professor in a University system or 10 years of experience in an equivalent position in reputed research and / or academic organization.
The post carries a fixed pay of **Rs.2,10,000/-** (Rupees two lakhs and ten thousand) with Special Allowance of **Rs.11,250/-** per month and other usual allowances such as Dearness Allowance. Provision of pay protection is applicable for candidates belonging to Central or State Government Public University or Institution. The tenure of the Vice-Chancellor will be four years from the date he/ she assumes office or till he/she attains 70 years of age; whichever is earlier.
Instructions for Submission of Application for the Post of Vice-Chancellor of Sambalpur University
Applicants are advised to strictly adhere to the following guidelines while submitting their applications:
1. **Application Format and Submission Platforms**
+ Applications must be submitted **physically in the prescribed format (and digitally in HIMS website of which details shared below)** available for download at the Department's website www.dhe.odisha.gov.in and the websites of the concerned University.
+ Applicants are also required to fill out the required application digitally in the HIMS Portal available at : hims.odisha.gov.in/ **Application-for-post-of-VC**.
+ The completed physical application form must be scanned and sent via **e-mail in PDF format only to hedsec.od@od.gov.in** with the subject line : "Application for the post of Vice-Chancellor of Sambalpur University".
+ After the scanned copy is sent through email, applicants are required to send the hard copy of the application physically to the department at the following address with clear mention at the envelope - "**Application for the post of Vice-Chancellor of Sambalpur University**".
• **Address :**
Office of Commissioner Cum Secretary, Higher Education Department, LokSeva Bhawan, Sachivalaya Marg, Bhubaneswar-751001.
+ The e-mail submission must be accompanied by the physical submission through Speed Post (India Post) and digitally in the HIMS portal as stated above, failure of which will lead to rejection of the application.
2. **Submission Deadline**
• Both the **e-mailed application (PDF format)** and the **HIMS Module** must be submitted no later than **23:55 hours on 23.10.2026**.
• **Failure to complete both submissions** (HIMS Module and email) by the specified deadline shall result in **rejection of the application**.
3. **Submission of Hard Copy**
• In addition to the online submission, a **hard copy** of the same application (as e-mailed), **duly ink-signed** and accompanied by all supporting documents, must be sent by **SPEED POST (India Post) only and not through courier** to the undersigned. Any other mode of submission of application will be liable for rejection.
• The hard copy should reach the Department's office **on or before 30.10.2026**. However, any **hard copy of the applications received after 30.10.2026** will be **rejected**, even if the same is posted before the deadline through email and HIMS Module.
4. **Other Conditions**
• In case **multiple applications** are submitted by a candidate, only the **last valid submission** digitally submitted on HIMS portal (as per time / stamp of the HIMS Module) will be considered. All previous submissions shall be rejected.
• **Late applications** received after the aforementioned deadlines via email, HIMS Module, or Indian Post **will not be considered** under any circumstances.
5. **Interview Process**
• Shortlisted candidates will be called for an interview before a **three-member Selection Committee**. The **venue and schedule** will be communicated in due course.
Commissioner-cum-Secretary to Government
Higher Education Department
Lok Seva Bhawan, Sachivalaya Marg
Bhubaneswar-751001. Phone:-(0674) 2536862
11001/330/2627 OIPR-11001/11001/11/26-27/0058

Namibian cheetah Gaurav died in Madhya Pradesh's Kuno National Park on Monday evening while undergoing treatment, an official said. Ten-year-old Gaurav was rescued from the wild on September 12 after he was observed to be weak and dull. The director said based on the preliminary clinical examination, an underlying chronic condition was suspected. "Despite continued treatment and supportive care, his condition deteriorated, and he died at around 4 p.m. on Monday," he said, adding that the exact cause of the death will be ascertained after post-mortem examination. Kuno National Park now has 51 cheetahs, the director said.

The Supreme Court on Monday sought a response from the States of Maharashtra and Haryana on a plea by stand-up comedian Pranit More to club FIRs registered against him in connection with the '₹370 biryani' controversy. A three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant also issued notice to the Union government. The Maharashtra Cyber Police had registered an FIR against Mr. More, the member of the audience, Himanshu Jangra, and another person under various provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita. A separate petition had been filed by an advocate over Mr. More's show which had been held in Gurugram.

Six persons have been arrested for molesting a woman doctor and assaulting her husband and other friends in a movie hall at Kolkata's Acropolis Mall on Sunday night. According to police, the couple went to watch a movie with their friends in the mall. Six men started intimidating her by making obscene gestures and derogatory comments. When her husband and friends protested, the accused assaulted them. A case under Sections 115(2) (voluntarily causing hurt), 79 (outraging woman's modesty), 126 (wrongful restraint) under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita have been booked against them.

Union Road Transport Minister Nitin Gadkari said on Monday the government will soon notify a policy rewarding safe driving with lower insurance premiums and penalising rash driving and traffic violations. "Good drivers should pay less for insurance; reckless drivers and rule-breakers should face penalties," he said. He said this would promote better road manners. The Minister had earlier said the government was planning a system to make drivers more accountable. Under the proposal, every traffic offence would lead to points being cut from a person's driving licence and vehicle registration. If too many points pile up, the licence or registration certificate could be suspended.

"India is today the country with the largest young population in the world, and therefore, the responsibility of the youth is the greatest. The present generation needs to avoid 'shortcuts' in life. Today's youth may watch 'reels', but what they truly like is what is 'real', that is, reality," he said.

The law officer requested the CJI to constitute the Bench to facilitate the NHAI to make its request for a modification of the court's direction of November last year.

FAITH

Narada visits Valmiki

Valmiki Ramayana begins with Narada's visit to Valmiki's ashram. Narada was a distinguished sage and the son of Brahma. So, Valmiki asked him some questions. He listed 16 qualities and asked Narada who had all these qualities. But he laid down some conditions. The possessor of those qualities had to be alive at the time. He had to be living in bhuloka and he had to be a human being. The answer to Valmiki's question was obvious, because Lord Narayana had come to earth as a human being in the Rama avatara. Rama was in bhuloka at that time. Valmiki had Rama in mind when he put the question to Narada, said M.A. Venkatakrishnan in a discourse. Although he knew about Rama, he wanted to hear Narada talking about Him.

Instead of asking Narada directly to tell him about Rama, Valmiki asked him indirectly. When did this visit of Narada to Valmiki's ashram take place? It was when Rama was king of Ayodhya and Sita too was still there, not yet having been banished. Rama must have been between 40 and 45 years of age at that time. From the Valmiki Ramayana, we can infer that Rama was 12 when He married Sita. She must have been about six then. They were happy together in Ayodhya for 12 years. Rama had completed 24 years and was entering His 25th year, when He was banished. He spent 14 years in the forest. So, He must have been 39 when He returned. His coronation took place after His return to Ayodhya.

Narada met Valmiki in the latter's ashram on the banks of the Tamasa river. This place is near Kanpur, in Uttar Pradesh. But before Valmiki moved here, he had his ashram in Chitrakuta.

Business

INBRIEF



NSE IPO gets nearly 4 times subscription on final day

The ₹22,569-crore initial public offering of the National Stock Exchange of India (NSE), the country's second-largest public issue, received 3.92 times subscription so far on the final day of bidding on Monday. The IPO received bids for 34.78 crore (34,78,26,096) shares against 8.86 crore (8,86,42,911) shares on offer, as per details available with BSE till 02:35 p.m. The category for Qualified Institutional Buyers (QIBs) garnered 7.99 times subscription. PTI

Elevate Campuses to raise ₹2,100 crore via IPO

Hillhouse Investment backed Elevate Campuses Ltd., an education platform owning, operating and managing on-campus student accommodations across private higher education institutions (HEIs) and K-12 assets, is planning to raise ₹2100 crore through an IPO at a price band of ₹343 to ₹362 per share with face value of ₹1. It will be the first student housing REIT type platform to be listed in India. Bids will open on September 23 and close on September 25. PTI

Money View to raise ₹1,092 crore through IPO

Digital lending service provider Money View Ltd. is planning to raise ₹1,092 crore through an initial public offer. The IPO comprises a fresh issue of shares worth ₹750 crore and the current owners diluting ₹342 crore of their stake. The company has fixed a price band of ₹32-34 a piece. Bids can be made for a minimum lot of 441 equity shares and multiples thereof. The IPO opens for subscription on September 24 and closes on September 28, 2026.

‘Critical mineral reuse issues being tackled’

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A whole-of-government approach is being followed to address issues concerning the recycling industry for critical minerals, G. Kishan Reddy, Union Mines Minister told the media on the sidelines of an event here.



G Kishan Reddy

“The issues [concerning the broader industry] are not just related to the Union Mines Ministry but to several other Ministries as well,” he stated, adding, “Discussions have been held with several Ministries with a whole of government approach, including electronics, finance, commerce and environment, among others,

and efforts are being made to address them.”

The Union Minister also assured his Ministry had taken note of recyclers’ demand for scrapping the mandatory Pre-Shipment Inspection Certificate (PSIC) and discussions would be held with the relevant Ministries to reach an amicable solution on the issue.

Report on reserves of Chilean copper blocks in 3 months: HCL

Mithun Dasgupta
KOLKATA

After four copper blocks in Chile were shortlisted for due diligence, State-run Hindustan Copper Ltd. (HCL) said work was underway on forming a joint-venture with Codelco, its Chilean strategic partner, to take it to the next level.



Anupam Misra

In an interview with *businessline*, HCL CMD Anupam Misra said the transaction advisor is likely to submit a report on the total reserves in these blocks in two to three months.

“Certain things are at the study stage at present. If any one of them is a mature block, it may take six to eight years to start production,” Mr. Misra said.

The firm, India’s only vertically-integrated copper producer, is exploring overseas resource opportunities via collaboration with Codelco, Chile’s state-owned copper mining firm, in an attempt to boost India’s long-term resource security.

‘Nearly 40% of coal power plants critically low on fuel’

The number of power plants with critically low coal stocks of less than 25% of the required inventory rose sharply to 74 as of September 19 from about 60 plants last week, data show

Reuters
NEW DELHI

Nearly 40% of India’s coal-fired power plants are operating with critically low fuel stocks due to a surge in power demand amid hotter-than-usual weather linked to El Niño, government data showed on Monday.

The number of power plants with critically low coal stocks of less than 25% of the required inventory or only able to generate power for less than three days rose sharply to 74 as of September 19 from about 60 plants last week, data from the Central Electricity Authority that is updated daily showed.

India’s peak power de-



Power struggle: India’s peak power demand has been hovering between 230 gigawatts and 250 gigawatts in the past week. REUTERS

mand, a measure of the maximum electricity requirement, has been hovering between 230 gigawatts and 250 gigawatts in the past week.

Peak power demand hit an all-time high of 270.70

gigawatts in May.

The decline in power plant stocks appears to be a temporary logistical issue rather than a sign of any structural supply constraints, Crisil analysts said. India’s coal and rail-

way ministries said in early September they were increasing supplies to the plants after erratic monsoon rains had impacted shipments.

Renewable power generation rose about 21% between April and August, but due to the intermittent nature of clean energy, coal-fired power continued to play a critical role in meeting round-the-clock demand, Crisil said.

Meanwhile, Indian power producers’ coal imports in August rose to a 15-month high as a heatwave boosted electricity demand while hydroelectric power generation remained subdued, prompting utilities to turn to costly overseas supplies, *Reuters* reported last week.

SP Group bonds offered at premium on Tata Sons stake-sale plan, bankers say

Reuters
MUMBAI

Deutsche Bank and other investors are offering rupee-denominated bonds of a Shapoorji Pallonji Group firm at a premium, encouraged by the group’s plans to sell part of its stake in Tata Sons, three merchant bankers said on Monday.

Tata Trusts, the con-

trolling shareholder in Tata Sons, last week said SP Group proposed to sell part of its stake worth ₹250 billion (\$2.61 billion).

Much-needed funds

That would give much-needed funds to the debt-laden infrastructure and construction conglomerate, the second-largest shareholder in Tata Sons.

SP Group entity Eqyizen

Investment had raised ₹213.50 billion through three-year zero-coupon bonds at a yield of 18.9% in July. The bonds are now being offered at a yield of around 18.70%-18.75%, the bankers said, requesting anonymity as they are not authorised to speak to the media.

Eqyizen’s bonds are secured by SP Group’s stake in Tata Sons. Held through Cyrus Invest-

ments. SP Group and Deutsche Bank, which structured the bond sale and was also a large investor in the issue, did not respond to *Reuters* requests for comment.

“Deutsche Bank has the bonds on its books and is actively seeking buyers to exit at some profit,” one of the bankers said.

“We have not seen major trades (yet).”

RBI ups FCNR(B) inflows to \$133 bn

Ashokamithran T.
MUMBAI

The special window for Non-Resident Indians (NRIs) to park funds in Indian banks through Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) or FCNR(B) deposits received an overwhelming response, attracting around \$133 billion in inflows at its closure on August 31.

As per Reserve Bank of India (RBI) data on September 21, FCNR(B) deposits accounted for the bulk of the dollar-denominated capital inflows into Indian banks. Overseas foreign currency borrowings and external commercial borrowings contributed \$5.3 billion each, taking the to-

tal inflow via these channels to \$143.6 billion as of August 31.

Easing rupee pressure

The scheme was unveiled by the RBI to support foreign exchange inflows and contain pressure on the rupee. RBI’s update on September 2 showed banks mobilised about \$127 billion via dollar-denominated FCNR(B) deposits.

The large inflows provided banks with a stable source of medium-term foreign currency funding at a time when lenders have been facing elevated credit-deposit ratios. However, S&P cautioned that the inflow surge is unlikely to be repeated at the same scale in the future.

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमंडल, चतरा
eercdchatra-jhr@nic.in

(शुद्धि पत्र)

एतद् द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमण्डल, चतरा द्वारा दिनांक 24.09.2026 को प्राप्त की जाने वाली निविदा, जो **PR No.- PR-388741(Road)-26-27(D)** द्वारा ई० प्रोक्योरमेंट नोटिस सं० – 05/2026-27 (1stCall) आमंत्रित की गई है। ई० प्रोक्योरमेंट नोटिस सं० – 05/2026-27 (1stCall) को अपरिहार्य कारणों से निरस्त किया जाता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता,
प०नि०वि०, पथ प्रमण्डल,
चतरा

PR 390279 Road(26-27)#D

TASMAC TAMIL NADU STATE MARKETING CORPORATION LIMITED
CMDA TOWER - II, IV FLOOR, GANDHI IRWIN BRIDGE ROAD, EGMORE, CHENNAI - 600 008.
Phone: 044- 28521970, 044-28524589 Email id - tasmac.msection@gmail.com

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

TamilNadu State Marketing Corporation Ltd (TASMAC) invites online tenders/bids in two cover system (Cover I/Technical bid and Cover II/Financial Bid) for supply of Heavy Duty Steel Racks(Main Racks and Add on Racks) on Rate Contract from eligible and reputed GST registered manufacturers of heavy-duty steel racks located in TamilNadu, or the authorized representatives of the manufacturers who are located outside TamilNadu.

TAMILNADU STATE MARKETING CORPORATION LIMITED
CMDA TOWER-II, IV FLOOR, GANDHI IRWIN BRIDGE ROAD, EGMORE, CHENNAI - 600 008.
Phone: 044- 28521970, 044-28524589

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (For publishing in the Website)
Tender Reference No. TASHO/2328/2026- M4-Part (1)

Office of Issue	Tamil Nadu State Marketing Corporation Limited, Corporate Office, Egmore, Chennai - 600008.
Tender Reference No.	TASHO/2328/2026-M4-Part (1)
Tender forms available at	https://tenders.gov.in/nicgep/app
Date of Issue/Publishing	21-09-2026 02:00 PM
Bid submission start date and time	25-09-2026 10:00 A.M
Pre Bid Meeting (Venue: TASMAC Corporate Office, Egmore)	23-09-2026 11:00 A.M
Last date for receipt of Bid Queries	28-09-2026 11:00 A.M
Bid submission last date and time	06-10-2026 02:00 PM
Date and time of opening of Technical bid	06-10-2026 05:00 PM
Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Rs. 2,50,000/-
Bid validity	The Bid remain valid for a period of not less than 120 days from the last date of submission of the bid.
Place of opening of technical bid	TASMAC, Corporate Office, Egmore, Chennai-8.

1. The tender document can be downloaded from the portal <https://tenders.gov.in/nicgep/app>.
2. Tenderers are advised to follow the instructions provided in the **Tender document for the submission of the bids through online e-procurement system of Government of Tamil Nadu** website. <https://tenders.gov.in>

Note: If any of the dates mentioned above is declared as Government Holiday or unplanned shutdown by the State, the due date will be postponed to the next working day at the same scheduled time. To enable TASMAC to meet the target dates, bidders are expected to respond promptly to any clarifications requested during the evaluation process. TASMAC will adhere to the above schedule to the best of its ability, but reserves the right to modify it. Notification of any changes will be provided to all bidders.

DIPR / 2907/ TENDER / 2026 **Managing Director**

S. E. RAILWAY - TENDER

Tender No. SER-OL-HQ-TR-W-TSR-09-26 Chief Track Engineer, South Eastern Railway, Kolkata-700043, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites Open E- Tender for the following work on Engineering, Procurement & Construction (EPC) Mode:-

1. Name of the Work: Through Sleeper Renewal (P) by Agency's Track laying (PQRS/SQRS/ QRS/TELE) portal and material (Except Rail) complete at Purulia Jn. Chanduli Jn. TSR(P) (DN)- 20.281 Tkm., Purulia Jn. Chanduli Jn. TSR(P) (UP) - 16.289 Tkm, Kharagpur Bhadrak (UP & DN) - TSR(P) -49.619 Tkm, (KGP & AORADivision) Total TSR(P) =86.189 Tkm. In SER. **2.Approx. Cost of the Work:** Rs. 94.20,42,784.13/- **3. Earnest Money:** Rs. 1,88,40,900.00 /- **4. Date and time of Closing of Tender:** 16.12.2026 at 15:00 Hrs. **5. Website particulars:** Complete details for e-tendering and online participation for the above work are on website www.ireps.gov.in. (PR No.-786)

UPI heads towards a code-less era, a decade after debut

Ashokamithran T.
MUMBAI



QR code is going to be a thing of the past.

A decade after the launch of the Unified Payments Interface (UPI), payment companies are moving towards a new phase of digital payments that seeks to make transactions faster and do away with one-time passwords (OTPs) and QR codes.

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Governor last week launched a 'tap and pay' facility for UPI transactions in partnership with the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI), enabling payments through RuPay credit cards without the need for OTPs or QR codes.

The facility was unveiled at the Global Fintech Fest 2026 in Mumbai.

The new feature uses the point-of-sale (PoS) terminal's internet connectivity, allowing a transaction to be completed even when the customer's mobile device does not have internet access. NPCI said the facility is currently available for transactions of up to ₹5,000. For higher-value transactions, customers will have to enter their PIN.

UPI has emerged as India's dominant electronic payment system, accounting for about 85% of transactions. Introduced in the aftermath of demonetisation, its rapid adoption has been driven largely by the convenience of making retail and utility payments without the need for cash.

However, the growing

scale of digital payments has also brought heightened concerns over fraud, including incidents involving the theft or inadvertent sharing of OTPs and other authentication credentials.

In response, the RBI mandated a two-factor authentication for UPI transactions from April 1, 2026, prompting payment companies to develop alternatives that combine security with ease of use.

Visa and Mastercard, for instance, have introduced passkeys as an additional authentication mechanism. Mastercard has also showcased its Consumer Device Cardholder Verification Method (CDCVM), which allows transactions to be authenticated through a device's biometric capabilities, including fingerprint or facial recognition. Mastercard has partnered with Google Pay to offer the service.

Amazon Pay, which accounts for less than 1% of UPI transactions, has also introduced a tap-and-pay facility for its partner merchants as it seeks to expand its presence in the digital payments market.

Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

JAPIT
Jharkhand Agency for Promotion of Information Technology
(An Autonomous Body under the Department of Information Technology & e-Governance, Govt. of Jharkhand) Ground Floor, Engineers Hostel - I, Near Golchakkar, Dhurwa, Ranchi, Jharkhand
Phone: 0651-2401067 / 2401044 | Email: japit_doit@rediffmail.com

NIQ No.:JAPIT/2019 **Date: 18/09/2026**
NOTICE INVITING QUOTATION

S. No	Name of the Work	Selection of Chartered Accountant Firm for providing Internal Audit and related Financial/Tax Advisory Services to Jharkhand Agency for Promotion of Information Technology (JAP IT)
1	Scope of Work	As mentioned in the Request for Proposal (RFP)
2	Availability of Bid Documents	As mentioned in the Request for Proposal (RFP)
3	Mode of Submission of Bid	By Speed Post / Registered Post / By Hand in a sealed envelope
4	Cost of Tender Document and EMD (in INR)	Cost of Tender Document: Rs. 1,000/- (Rupees One Thousand only) via Demand Draft EMD: Rs. 50,000/- (Rupees Fifty Thousand only) via Demand Draft
5	Start Date of Downloading of RFP Document	[21/09/2026] from www.japit.jharkhand.gov.in / JAP IT website
6	Date of Start of Submission of Bids	21/09/2026, 11:00 AM
7	Last Date of Bid Submission	30/09/2026, upto 05:00 PM
8	Last Date of Receipt of Tender Fee and EMD	30/09/2026, upto 05:00 PM
9	Date of Technical Bid Opening	01/10/2026 at 03:00 PM
10	Name and Address of Office Inviting Quotation	Jharkhand Agency for Promotion of Information Technology (JAP IT), Ground Floor, Engineers Hostel - I, Near Golchakkar, Dhurwa, Ranchi
11	Tender Document	Tender document can be downloaded from the JAP-IT website or physically collected from office of the JAP-IT

Sd/-Officer on Special Duty
Jharkhand Agency for Promotion of Information Technology
PR 390246 (Information Technology)26-27"D

Jharkhand State Building Construction Corporation Limited
(Govt. of Jharkhand Undertaking) Corporation Identification No.-U45201JH2015SGC003325
Regd. Office:-Building Construction Department, Govt. of Jharkhand, Project Building, P.O.-Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004, Jharkhand
Phone No.:-0651-2446257/2446258/2446259,e-mail:-jsbccljharkhand@gmail.com

Notice No. JSBCC/LRFP/03/2026-27 **Date:- 21.09.2026**
VERY SHORT NOTICE INVITING REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL FOR
Consultancy Services for Environmental Clearance (EC), Environmental Management Plan (EMP), and Compliance Monitoring for Construction of 2,800 Bedded Multi Specialty Teaching Hospital Cum Medical College at Ranchi (Jharkhand) 2nd Call NO.03/2026-27

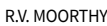
Jharkhand State Building Construction Corporation Limited (JSBCCCL) hereby invites proposal from qualified, experienced and financially sound consultants, interested in providing Environmental Clearance (EC), Environmental Management Plan (EMP), and Compliance Monitoring for Construction of 2,800 Bedded Multi Specialty Teaching Hospital Cum Medical College at Ranchi (Jharkhand). Detailed scope of work, Eligibility criteria, Selection mechanism, Evaluation procedure and other terms and conditions can be seen in the Request for proposal (RFP) document. Copy of the Request for Proposal (RFP) document can be downloaded from the e-tendering portal of Jharkhand Tenders i.e. www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in from **24.09.2026 till 29.09.2026**.

Nodal Officer,e-Procurement Cell, Jharkhand State Building Construction Corporation Ltd., Ranchi.

PR 390317 (Jharkhand State Building Construction Corp. Ltd.)26-27"D

CM
YK

This bronze medal is more than
my life, says MMA fighter Suchika



Deepika, Rutuja and Navneet do the trick as India routs Indonesia



Savita becomes highest-capped Indian women's hockey player



'Never thought I'd be playing in Japan, shows cricket is picking up'



Himanshu comes of age as marksmen get going

The youngster pips senior pro Rudrankksh to silver in 10m air rifle in a dramatic final; the two, along with Parth, also bag a silver in the team event; China's Sheng retains his individual title

Wrestling was too hard: Himanshu on choosing shooting

Unkindest cut of all for Suchika

India and Sri Lanka tussle in yet another continental title clash

SNAPSHOTS

CSK names Zaheer as coach for IPL 2027

The former pacer replaces Fleming who had an 18-year stint; it remains to be seen whether his appointment is a short-term arrangement

CRICKET

S. Dipak Ragav
CHENNAI

Chennai Super Kings (CSK) has appointed former India pacer Zaheer Khan as its head coach for IPL 2027. Zaheer replaces Stephen Fleming who guided the Yellow Brigade from 2009 to 2026.

The former New Zealand skipper was removed from the job earlier this year after three poor seasons for the five-time champion, in which it failed to qualify for the playoffs.

Interestingly, Zaheer will be on a one-year contract. With the mega auction set to take place before 2028, it remains to be seen if this is a short-term arrangement.

Zaheer has previously been part of the coaching set-up with Mumbai Indians and Lucknow Super Giants.



Zaheer. FILE PHOTO

Rupa Gurunath, owner, CSK, said: "We are pleased to confirm Zaheer as the head coach. Zaheer's distinguished playing career and proven ability to nurture young talent make him a valuable addition to our set-up. We are confi-

It's an honour to be a part of one of the most successful teams in the IPL. I can't wait to join the franchise with such a rich history

dent that his guidance will help strengthen the core of the franchise."

K.S. Viswanathan, Managing Director, CSK, said Zaheer will have the freedom to choose his own support staff.

"He's one of the finest cricketing brains, and we look forward to having him in our family," Zaheer said: "It's an honour to be a part of one of the most successful teams in the IPL. I have faced CSK on the field and have thoroughly enjoyed the contests. The atmosphere created by the superfans at Chepauk makes it even more special. I can't wait to join the franchise with such a rich history".

Tactical skills and Dhoni's nod seal the deal for Zaheer

S. Dipak Ragav
CHENNAI

Chennai Super Kings has been a symbol of stability, and it is often cited as a key reason for its success over the years. So, when the five-time champion parted ways with head coach Stephen Fleming after an 18-year long association earlier this year, there was suspense as to who would fill the New Zealander's shoes.

After months of deliberation, the team announced on Monday that Zaheer Khan will take over as head coach for 2027, and the decision clearly bears the imprint of former skipper M.S. Dhoni.

"We take all our decisions after discussing with Dhoni, and once he suggested his name, the management spoke to Zaheer and convinced him. Zaheer is also tactically strong, especially at figuring out the opposition's game plans.

"Ruturaj Gaikwad and the players are excited to work with him," said CSK Managing Director K.S. Viswanathan.

The Men in Yellow haven't qualified for the



Great rapport: Zaheer and Dhoni share a close bond from their playing days. FILE PHOTO: K.R. DEEPAK

playoffs since their title-winning run in 2023.

More importantly, the team had a poor mega auction in 2025 and is bearing the consequences of those missteps. Though some of them have been addressed, especially in the batting department, the line-up is still far from settled.

With one more year before the mega auction, the team needs to maximise its resources, and the management feels Zaheer can make an impact.

"We needed a coach who can gel well with the players, and Zaheer is the right choice for that. He is technically very strong and bowling is an area where

Andre appointed TN vice-captain

RANJI TROPHY

S. Dipak Ragav
CHENNAI

R. Sai Kishore will lead Tamil Nadu in the Ranji Trophy 2026-27 season that begins next month. The TNCA senior selection committee has picked a 16-member squad for the opening fixture against Rajasthan, to be played in Jaipur from October 11 to 14.

Alongside the regulars, left-arm spinner S. Ajith Ram returns after missing out last year due to injury. The squad features promising pacers R.D. Pranav Ragavendra and D. Deepesh. The youngsters are known for their ability to bowl at a brisk pace, something TN has not had in a while.

While Pranav made his debut in the 2024-25 season, Deepesh has received his maiden call-up.

"We got good feedback about Pranav during the recent India under-19 tour to Sri Lanka. These two are the future, and we want to allow them to mature. In three years, they will be the backbone of our attack," said Sunil Subramanian, chairman of the selection committee.

Meanwhile, C. Andre Siddarth, who will play in his third season, has been named vice-captain. The 20-year-old was TN's third-highest run-scorer (409



Andre... getting promoted. FILE PHOTO: K. MURALI KUMAR

runs) last term. "He led the side well in the intra-squad game, and we are looking at grooming him for the future," Sunil added.

On promising opener B. Sachin not making the cut, Sunil said that with S.R. Athish being the back-up wicketkeeper and G. Ajitesh doing well in the practice match, he had to miss out.

The squad: R. Sai Kishore (Capt.), C. Andre Siddarth (Vice-capt.), G. Ajitesh (wk), S. Ajith Ram, S.R. Athish, D. Deepesh, G. Govinath, J. Hemchudeshan, B. Indrajith, N. Jagadeesan, Nidhish S. Rajagopal, Pradosh Ranjan Paul, R.D. Pranav Ragavendra, P. Saravana Kumar, R. Sonu Yadav, R. Vimal Khumar.

Standby/development squad: B. Aaditya, A. Esakkimuthu, Manav Parakh, S. Radhakrishnan, B. Sachin.



Calicut FC defender Rijohn dies in road accident

Sports Bureau
KOZHIKODE

Footballer Rijohn Jose passed away following a road accident at the Gandhi Road Flyover in Kozhikode on Sunday night.

He was 29 and played as a defender for Calicut FC in the Super League Kerala (SLK). Another teammate, Gani Ahammed Nigam, was with Rijohn at the time of the accident and is undergoing treatment.

He sustained no serious injuries, according to a release from Calicut FC.

Rijohn, who belonged to Ollur (Thrissur), was part of the Calicut FC team that emerged as the champion in the inaugural SLK in 2024.

Before joining the Kozhikode-based club, he had played for Sreebhumi FC, George Telegraph SC, FC Deccan and Forca Kochi FC.

Chance for India's emerging talent to enhance credentials

AUSTRALIA-A IN INDIA

Abhishek Saini
PUDUCHERRY

India's emerging First Class talent will strive to burnish its credentials even further as India-A hosts Australia-A in the first 'Test' at the Siam Cricket Stadium here, starting on Tuesday.

Devdutt Padikkal lived up to his billing with two hundreds in Sri Lanka last month and will lead the side, hoping to add to his growing reputation. B. Sai Sudharsan, who is returning after a foot injury, and Anshul Kamboj are the only other capped players in the squad.

The selectors have rewarded young batters Aman Mokhad, Ayush Pandey, Kumar Kushagra, and Shaik Rasheed for their domestic hauls. But India-A's only spin options, Shams Mulani and Tanush Kotian, are also all-rounders, and will probably squeeze out one outright batter at the top.

In the three First Class games at this venue last season, spinners picked 52 wickets at 23.32 while the quicks were limited to just 16 wickets at an average of more than 36. It is precisely why Australia-A has included Todd Murphy and



In the spotlight: Padikkal will look to continue his good form and lead from the front. FILE PHOTO: R. RAGU

Corey Rocchiccioli in its starting XI for the game.

The visitor also boasts of an experienced batting line-up in Peter Handscomb, Nathan McSweeney, Josh Philippe, and Sam Konstas, and most will take this series as an audition for the upcoming Border-Gavaskar Trophy in India early next year.

The teams (from): India-A: Devdutt Padikkal (Capt.), Sai Sudharsan (Vice-capt.), Aman

Handscomb eyes Test return through the Australia-A route

Abhishek Saini
PUDUCHERRY

Peter Handscomb has been one of the highest run-scorers in Sheffield Shield in recent seasons and the 35-year-old said having a clear gameplan has helped him stand out of the pack.

"I've done a fair bit of work over the last four or five years on my technique and changing a few things. But also, the mental challenge and making sure that your gameplan is clear. It's something I've worked pretty hard on as well.

"Understanding where you can and can't score and what shots you can



Hungry for runs: Handscomb says having a clear gameplan has helped him. GETTY IMAGES

ATP needs to promote doubles more: Rajeev Ram

TENNIS

Ashwin Achal
BENGALURU

Proposals to make major changes to men's doubles, set to be enacted in 2028, have raised concerns over the future of the discipline.

There is apprehension over moves to halve doubles entries at ATP Tour events, and to cut the prize money share for doubles.

Former World No. 1 doubles player Rajeev Ram believes the governing body should do more to promote doubles rather than resort to measures that could restrict opportunities for players.

"The ATP should do a little bit more to promote the discipline of doubles. Most people, as amateurs and recreational players, play doubles.

"We have some amazing stories to be told. The team aspect of doubles, which lends itself to great stories,

is untapped right now. So instead of talking about cutting, I would love to see more being done to promote doubles," Rajeev Ram said here on Monday.

A six-time Grand Slam champion, Rajeev Ram retired after his men's doubles semifinal exit at the U.S. Open earlier this month.

The 42-year-old American, who has family roots in Bengaluru, was felicitated by the Karnataka State Lawn Tennis Association here on Monday.

Asked whether the proposed restrictions could discourage youngsters from pursuing a career in doubles, Rajeev Ram replied: "When I played singles for 13 years, a decent part of my income came from doubles.

"So it is not discouraging for just doubles players, but for tennis in general. It is discouraging for anyone looking to pursue a career in professional tennis," he said.

Uzbekistan hands India its first loss; women beat USA

CHESS OLYMPIAD

Sports Bureau

In perhaps the most anticipated match at the Chess Olympiad, India went down to Uzbekistan 1.5-2.5 at Samarkand on Monday. It was not just the clash between the world's two strongest nations in terms of young chess talent, but the one between the defending champion and the host.

It was India's first defeat in the competition, after registering five consecutive wins. The Indian women, however, bounced back after their disappointing loss in the previous round; they beat the United States 3-1.

The much-needed victory was fashioned by Vanti-



Rising to the occasion: Vantika played a key role in India's win. FIDE

ka Agrawal and B. Savitha Shri, after Koneru Humpy and Divya Deshmukh drew their games on the top two boards. It was Savitha's fifth win in as many games; she was rested in India's defeat to Poland in the previous round. She beat Rose

Atwell, while Vantika overcame Irina Krush in a long game, converting her advantageous position with patience, in 65 moves.

In the open section, it was Nihal Sarin's defeat on the third board to Nodirbek Yakubboev that

proved costly for India. Nihal had been playing rather well though, until he blundered on the 37th move with his knight, after which he was doomed. He continued to wage a losing battle until he resigned on the 54th move.

The other games, including the one on the second board between Arjun Erigaisi and Javokhir Sindarov, were drawn. Going into Tuesday's rest day, India is in the joint second position in both the open and women's sections.

Important results (sixth round): Open: Uzbekistan bt India 2.5-1.5 (R. Praggnanandhaa drew with Nodirbek Abdusattorov; Arjun Erigaisi drew with Javokhir Sindarov; Nihal Sarin lost to Nodirbek Yakubboev; D. Gukesh drew with Shamsiddin Vokhidov).

China bt Germany 3-1; England drew with France 2-2; USA bt Norway 2.5-1.5; Armenia bt Iran 2.5-1.5; Azerbaijan bt Argentina 2.5-1.5; Uzbekistan (2) bt Spain 1.5; Hungary drew with Romania 2-2; Netherlands bt Israel 4-0; Bulgaria bt Ukraine 2.5-1.5; Uzbekistan (2) bt Spain 2.5-1.5; Switzerland bt Turkiye 3-1; Belarus drew with Poland 2-2; Greece bt Indonesia 3.5-0.5.

Women: India bt USA 3-1 (Koneru Humpy drew with Carissa Yip; Divya Deshmukh drew with Alice Lee; Vantika Agrawal bt Irina Krush; B. Savitha Shri bt Rose Atwell).

Georgia bt Uzbekistan 3.5-0.5; Kazakhstan bt Azerbaijan 2.5-1.5; China bt Poland 3.5-0.5; France bt Vietnam 4-0; Ukraine bt England 2.5-1.5; Germany bt Romania 2.5-1.5; Netherlands drew with Slovenia 2-2; Serbia drew with Turkiye 2-2; Mongolia bt Iran 3-1; Armenia bt Latvia 3-1; Switzerland bt Italy 3-1; Belarus drew with Hungary 2-2.

Indu Puri chosen head of ad-hoc committee to administer TTFI

TABLE TENNIS

Amol Karhadkar
MUMBAI

The Indian Olympic Association (IOA) has formally constituted a three-member ad-hoc committee to administer the Table Tennis Federation of India (TTFI), with former National champion Indu Puri appointed as its chairperson.

The office order, issued by IOA president P. T. Usha on September 17, comes a little over a month after the Sports Ministry suspended TTFI's recognition as the National Sports Federation on August 12. The IOA said

the committee had been constituted as a "limited and time-bound interim sporting mechanism" in consultation with the International Table Tennis Federation (ITTF).

Indu Puri, 73, an eight-time National champion, will be joined by Namrata Chatterjee, a reputed sports lawyer, as the legal member and Dr. Andres Constantin, ITTF Governance Manager, as the third member.

The committee's mandate includes ensuring the day-to-day administration of the sport, athlete participation and compliance with the applicable legal, regulatory and ITTF frameworks.

The committee has been tasked with ensuring uninterrupted functioning of TTFI, including athlete registrations, selections and entries, while maintaining neutrality and transparency. It has also been empowered, where necessary, to coordinate with government agencies and sporting authorities.

The committee has initially been constituted for six months.

Any extension will require a written IOA decision following consultation with, and prior written approval of, the ITTF. The IOA may also expand its strength from three to a maximum of five members, if required.



R.V. MOORTHY

Rudranksh — Indian shooting’s ‘chosen one’

The 22-year-old, who clinched bronze in 10m air rifle at the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games, has overcome a dark phase with constant learning and determination; the versatile shooter hopes to ‘complete the set’ at the 2028 Olympics

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

Three years ago, Rudranksh Balasaheb Patil was being spoken of, in hushed but awed tone, as a possible successor to Abhinav Bindra.

The then 19-year-old’s performances and consistency had evoked admiration and hope in the shooting fraternity. But it all came crashing when he stumbled, finishing fourth in 10m air rifle at the 2023 Asian Games and failing to make the cut for the Paris Olympics – a quota he had held on to for two years after becoming the first Indian shooter to earn one. It wasn’t his skill that let him down; it was the mind. Still only 22, Rudranksh is now a lot more in control – of his mind, emotions, thoughts. That control saw him go one better on his disappointing Hangzhou outing, winning a bronze medal in 10m air rifle in Aichi-Nagoya.

Most importantly, the teenaged nervous energy has been replaced by a quietly confident one, a belief that he is good enough to succeed in not one but two events. He is representing India in both 10m air rifle and 50m rifle 3-Positions, the latter an addition after the Paris heartbreak in 2024.

Getting inspired

“As I see it, there are only a couple of athletes in the world who are doing well in two events. There are a lot of myths around balancing the two. When I started, there was a belief that if you do a second event, it will destroy your 10m form. There is also a thought that it’s difficult to manage both.

“But I was told by my nutritionist and psychologist that as long as you have two working legs and two working hands, you can do multiple events. That inspired me. And I saw Michael Phelps, who participated in multiple events and won multiple medals in all of them. So why not me? I have age on my side. I have a lot of years to make mistakes and learn through them,” the bespectacled youngster said in an exclusive interaction with *The Hindu* during the preparatory camp in Bhopal.

“This is the first Asian Games where I am participating in two events. It’s my fourth international competition doing so. Every time, I have improved a little bit. I have good coaches, good support staff. There is a lot of motivation. The hunger and greed is intact: if anything, it’s grown,” he added.

Content with third place

He has definitely learned. The bronze, which he clinched in 10m air rifle after leading for almost 70% of the competition here on Monday, might have been a disappointment at another time but for someone who has been in this position before, a medal was more than welcome.

“I am very happy with bronze because a lot of things could have gone wrong but all of it ended well. I would like to see the positives rather than the negatives,” he said.

Tough times

The aftermath of missing out on an Olympic outing was big, but for those around him more than himself. He hadn’t done badly: he finished third behind Arjun Babuta and Sandeep Singh in the trials.

“The sad part was seeing my parents and support staff. I was fine, honestly. My initial thought was: ‘I competed in 13 events and won 11. It’s just this one match that I lost, not a big deal’. But when I realised everyone was looking forward to that one match and were sad after watching me work hard, I was affected.

“I was actually sad because all the hard work which I had put in did not yield the result. But then, I started seeing the facts. It’s not that I was not selected because my score was bad: it was because one person shot a really high score. And I could not compete with that. Secondly, I always evaluate what I could have done better after a competition... the mistakes I made. But after that, I had nothing. I had given my best, my everything. I was able to figure things out and move forward.

“I started in a new event. My way of taking a break was getting back to shooting but it was on my terms. I used to go to the range but with no set schedule. I trained as I liked, whenever or however I liked... sometimes for hours, sometimes maybe for just 15 to 20 minutes. It was just a part of my life in which I had to be patient, I had to be persistent. I gradually built up my love for the sport again and started enjoying it,” Rudranksh explained the dark phase.

Finishing the job

There is also a determination to see his dreams, hard work and journey through to the end. It’s something that drives him, considering that the fear of leaving things midway has happened far too often for comfort.

“When I started my sporting journey, I was not exactly in a happy space in life. My marks (academics) were just fine. I was not good in other sports, I was new to the city and did not have many friends, I was lagging in everything. My parents used to get me some mechanical or Lego sets and I never completed any.

“It was a recurring complaint from my teachers that I was not completing anything. It became an obsession for me, it became a fixation that I want to do something in my life. I want to complete something. I started seeing athletes all over... Phelps. I had watched Bindra sir’s 2016 Olympics in Rio. All those sparked something in me. Even now, whenever things are not working out, I look around me for inspiration.

“A lot of athletes show up every day. Manu Bhaker, who is always on time, everywhere, always in the gym no matter what. Maybe, someone some day is as inspired by me as I am by others. That thought keeps me alive, gives me hope.”

He has learnt to stop worrying about things not in his control. Call it fate or luck, but Rudranksh prefers calling himself the ‘chosen one’ for all the unexpected setbacks he has faced, many of them not of his making. “I am kind of used to it by now. Even today (Monday), after my match was done, I picked up my rifle and the strap of the case broke. At the Peru World Cup, my gun auto-fired in the final and I was eliminated. Only my visa gets rejected,” he shrugged.

Showing maturity

The nervous, high-strung energy has settled into a quieter rhythm. It had helped him perform back then but had taken a toll on his health, both physical and mental. He suffered an auto-immune condition triggered by stress, messed up his sleep cycle and was desperate to continue regardless of everything – a lot like being on a high without drugs.

“When I lost, I would be down in the dumps. When I won, I used to feel like wanting to continue the streak no matter what – whether my sleep was affected, my hands were shaking, I was tired and ready to drop dead. Nothing mattered, only winning did. It has changed now but I am still learning how my body works. I learnt that fatigue is something which builds up during the Olympic time. I know I need to be more strategic and dissociated from the results.”

He knows he will make mistakes. He also knows that he will keep learning from them. Like Monday, when he admitted that slipping from No. 1 to No. 3 was largely his own doing – a poor 9.7 shot dashed his golden hopes.

“This gives me a kick, reminding me that I need to be calm till the last moment. I was too excited for the shot and I released before calming down. I think all the accumulated things over the last six months... perhaps it was just the way the body reacted once a medal was confirmed. The last time I spoke to you, I said I was looking to improve my rank, and that’s exactly what happened. Perhaps I need to watch what comes out of my mouth the next time,” he quipped.

External support

The support from the system has played a big role in his growth in 50m 3P. “The TOPS CEO then (Cmdr. P.K. Garg) was very supportive. He sanctioned my trip to Serbia for training with Olympic medallist Milenko Sebic. And he was impressed. The National coaches guided me on the right equipment, ammunition suppliers and provided the shots. Everything came together and in 2025, I participated in my first trials. I was in top-10, then top-6, now top-3. I hope to continue this.”

He is also aware that there is a long way to go. Aishwary Pratap Singh Tomar, who beat him in the shoot-off for the 10m bronze medal in Hangzhou, is the top guy in 50m 3P. While Rudranksh insists that there is no rivalry between the two, he is clear on the strengths of both.

“I don’t and can’t compare myself with him in 3P because he is the best in the country for the past seven to eight years. This year, I was able to play with

him in three international tournaments: my aim every time was to score around 587 points while he shot above 590 in all. I don’t compare myself with him in 10m because I feel I am better. I have proved myself in it more than him and I have been in the 10m team for as long as he’s been in 3P. But yes, there are times when he shoots 10m better than everyone. In fact, he is also one of my inspirations to try two events – if he can do it, why can’t I?”

The Asian Games will help him complete the first set of targets he has set for himself, a list that, by his own admission, has grown in reverse. From being crowned the World champion in 10m air rifle in his maiden senior international outing in 2022 to winning his first National title earlier this year, Rudranksh’s journey has been interesting, to say the least.

“I won the World championship, then the World Cup Final, World Cups, got the World No. 1 title, the World Record. This year, I won the Asian championship for the first time after finishing fourth repeatedly. The only regret is that despite all this, I have not even been considered for an Arjuna Award so far. I even won my first National-level tournament this year. But there is the Olympics to complete the set, maybe they will recognise after that,” he signed off.



There is determination to see his dreams, hard work and journey through to the end. It’s something that drives him, considering that the fear of leaving things midway has happened far too often



From being crowned the World champion in 10m air rifle in his maiden senior international outing in 2022 to winning his first National title earlier this year, Rudranksh’s journey has been interesting, to say the least

THE GIST

Rudranksh is now a lot more in control — of his mind, emotions, thoughts

The bronze might have been a disappointment at another time but for someone who has been in this position before, a medal was more than welcome

He feels he needs to be more strategic and dissociated from the results

Why scientists are rethinking the chemical ‘arms race’ against fungi

New research is showing that fungi are protected from antifungals by genetic mutations as well as by making more copies of protective genes, and it seems the idea of dousing fungal pathogens with antifungals is nearing its end; the next-generation of antifungals will need more planning

Somdatta Karak
HYDERABAD

For a long time, fungal infections have meant itchy skin, discoloured nails and sometimes hair loss. These symptoms are collectively called dermatophytosis and are caused by a group of fungi called dermatophytes. “Unfortunately, immunocompromised patients can get lesions all over their body. The itchiness and the lesions can get so severe that people even get suicidal thoughts,” said Shivaprakash Rudramurthy, Professor of medical mycology at the Postgraduate Institute of Medical Education and Research (PGIMER), Chandigarh.

Global warming

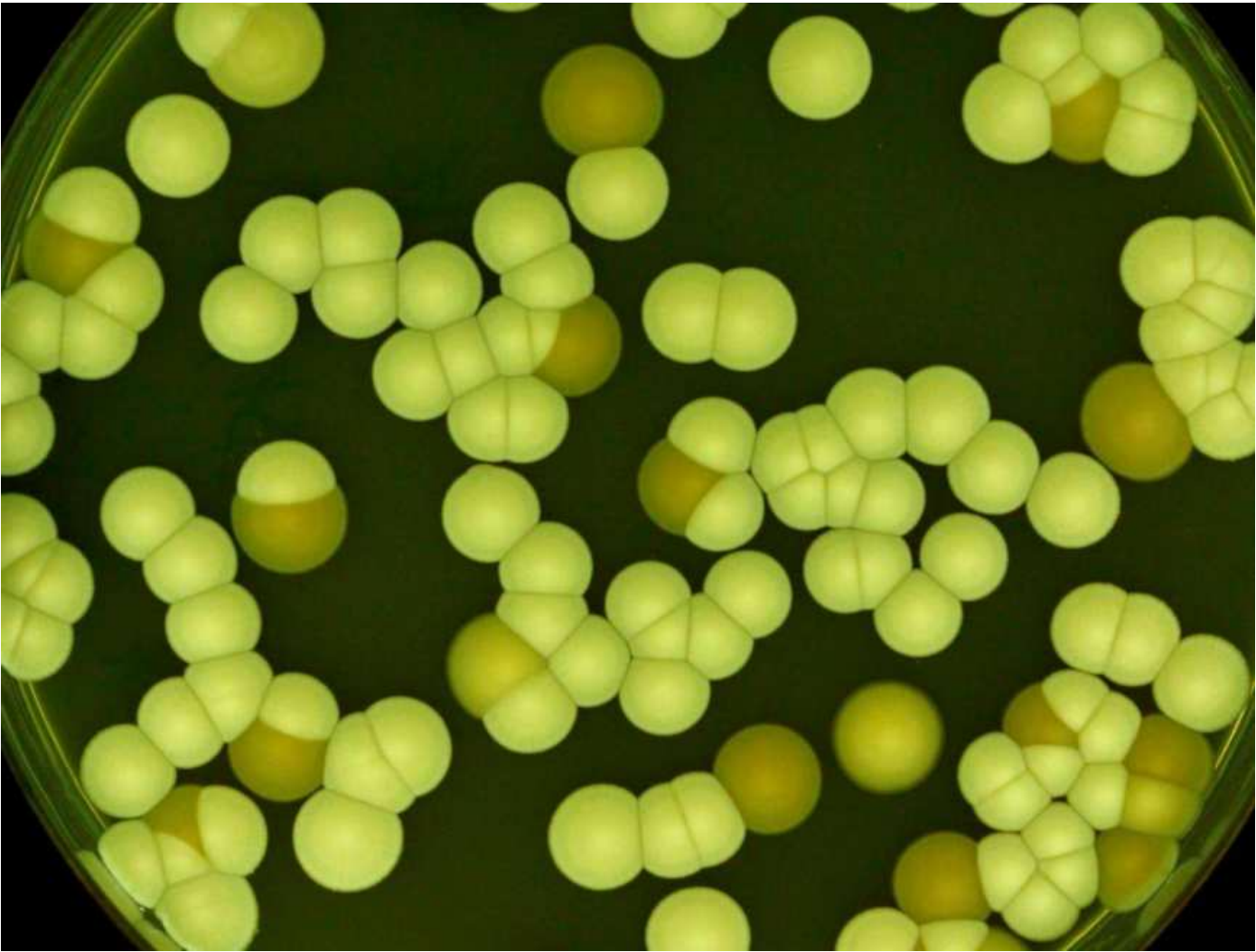
Dermatophytes are molds: fungi that grow in long strands. The other common category of fungi is yeast, which are single, oval-shaped cells. Among the yeasts, *Candida auris* is rapidly emerging as a multidrug resistant pathogen in ICU facilities. It enters the blood stream and causes severe infections, most of which are untreatable by the available antifungals. According to Professor Rudramurthy, those infected suffer a 30%-40% mortality rate. *C. auris* has become a menace only in the last two decades. The first report was in 2009 in Japan. Several other fungal species have become more pathogenic only in recent times. The cause of this rise remains unresolved but scientists and medical doctors have some ideas.

Fungi grow best in damp places below 30 degrees Celsius, so they can grow on our skin, especially in moist areas of the body, like armpits and the genital area. However, bloodstream infections in humans were rare because they could not survive in the body’s 37 degrees Celsius temperature.

“Fungal infections are common in cold-blooded animals with lower body temperatures,” Sriram Varahan, a mycologist at CSIR-Centre for Cellular and Molecular Biology, Hyderabad, said. “But global warming puts a selective pressure on fungi such that only the more heat-tolerant ones survive. These ones can survive inside our bodies too, if they gain access to it. This is called the fungal infection – mammalian selection hypothesis.”

Clinical samples

Today, roughly 20% of infections reported in hospitals are fungal in nature – yet most hospitals in India lack the capabilities and infrastructure to identify fungal pathogens, Professor Rudramurthy said. This prompted the PGIMER to begin storing fungal pathogens some 25 years ago. Today, the institute holds a stock of 15,000 clinical fungal isolates across India and helps other medical centres and clinicians identify and culture them for study, free of cost. The *C. auris* isolates from the PGIMER’s repository have come handy for Kaustuv Sanyal and his research associate Aswathy Narayanan, both at the Jawaharlal Nehru Centre for Advanced Scientific Research, Bengaluru. They study how fungal pathogens divide and their genomes evolve.



Candida auris growing in a nutrient-rich growth medium. The fungus has become a menace in the last two decades. PHANCANHTRINH (CC BY)

In a recent study published in *Nature Communications*, they characterised the clinical isolates of *C. auris* found across India. Their focus was the pathogen’s ability to resist antifungals. They were able to establish their findings in patient samples and go beyond earlier studies in model systems. “More than 90% clinical isolates of *C. auris* are resistant to common azole-based antifungals, such as fluconazole,” Professor Sanyal said. Some “30% of them are resistant to another class of antifungals called the polyenes. They mostly respond to a different class of antifungals called the echinocandins.” A drug may not work on a pathogen for many reasons, including the drug’s target becoming mutated or the drug’s effect being negated by the pathogen’s own biomolecules. Dr. Narayanan and her collaborators at the Indian Institute of Science Education and Research, Thiruvananthapuram, found significant changes in drug-resistant *C. auris* genomes that could explain why Indian clinical isolates were able to resist azoles and echinocandins.

Susceptibility tests

A fungal cell has two protective layers surrounding it. The outermost is the cell wall and the inner one is the cell membrane. Azole and polyene antifungals target a fat called ergosterol that is enriched in the cell membrane. Echinocandins target the cell wall. “When we grow *C. auris* isolates in the presence of fluconazole, the pathogen fights back by making extra copies of the *Erg 11* gene. This in turn helps in higher production of ergosterol, thereby

eliminating the effect of the azole drug,” Dr Narayanan said. The study found parts in the *C. auris* genome where additional copies of the *Erg11* gene were present. With echinocandin drugs such as caspofungin, the team found mutations in the *Fks1* gene that allowed the pathogen to resist the drug’s action. The team also found genetic changes promoting higher tolerance of echinocandins. “*Fks1* mutations can enable *C. auris* to survive even caspofungin doses up to 16 ug/ml. That means a patient with such a pathogen will need the drug at a concentration higher than 16 µg/ml,” Professor Sanyal said. “Today, clinicians would not know that because they test the pathogen’s ability to survive only until 2 µg/mL of caspofungin – as defined by the U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, and followed globally.” The logical thing for clinicians would be to look for mutations like in the *Fks1* gene and decide the limits for tests to decide the antifungal dose for patients. But due to associated costs, a more practical way is to increase the limits of susceptibility tests for caspofungin to higher than 16 ug/ml, Professor Sanyal added. *C. auris*, without any specific gene mutation or gene duplication, still responds to high concentrations of caspofungin in unexpected ways. While the pathogen dies at lower concentrations of the drug, at exceptionally high ones, it survives. This is paradoxical. “This is because caspofungin at high doses activates compensatory pathways in the fungus,” Professor Sanyal explained. “The fungus starts producing

chitin, the raw material of the fungal cell wall, in large quantities. Any damage that caspofungin brings about on the cell wall is compensated by the extra chitin production. And thus the cell wall remains intact despite the antifungal.” Such examples of paradoxical growth are called the Eagle effect, named for the U.S. pathologist Harry Eagle.

Beyond the arms race

The studies underline the importance of clinicians conducting more nuanced susceptibility tests to decide the antifungal doses. They show that fungi are protected from antifungals by genetic mutations as well as by making more copies of protective genes. Professor Sanyal also stressed on the need for a combination of therapies to target cellular compensatory pathways, keeping the major antifungals effective against drug-tolerant species. However, Dr. Varahan said he believed scientists and doctors need to think of gentler alternatives: “When we target [a molecule] without which an organism cannot live at all, evolution ensures that its population survives with a changed molecule. So instead of participating in an arms race, it is perhaps better to target the less critical molecular pathways, inhibition of which will allow the pathogen to still survive but not cause a disease.” It seems the idea of dousing fungal pathogens with antifungals is nearing its end. The next-generation of antifungals will need more planning.

(Somdatta Karak heads science communication at CSIR-CCMB. somdattakar@ccmb.res.in)



The Tilcayo measures about 46 cm long and weighs around 1.4 kg, making it smaller than the average domestic cat. REUTERS

Cat family gets a new Bolivian member after over a century

Reuters

A diminutive wild cat that inhabits Bolivia’s cloud forest has been identified as a previously unknown species, marking the first time a new living cat species has been formally named and described in more than a century. The cat, called Tilcayo by local communities, is part of a group called tiger cats found across much of South America. It was found in Bolivia’s lush Yungas forest, a mountainous region where forests are often covered by clouds and surrounded by high humidity, according to researchers. It measures about 46 cm long and weighs around 1.4 kg, making it smaller than the average domestic cat. Researchers used genetic data to confirm that the cat is a new species, and gave it the scientific name *Leopardus tilcayo*, retaining its local name. “Its fur is light brown ... with irregularly shaped rosettes across its body,” said Paola Nogales-Ascarrunz, a National Geographic explorer and one of the authors of the study describing the newly identified

Researchers used genetic data to confirm that the cat is a new species, and gave it the scientific name *Leopardus tilcayo*

species published on September 17 in the journal *Current Biology*. Little is yet known about the cat’s biology and lifestyle. Remains of small rodents in scat samples suggest they may form part of its diet, while camera-trap evidence indicates it could be more active at night, Ms. Nogales-Ascarrunz said. Tiger cats are so-called cryptic species, meaning they cannot easily be distinguished merely by appearance, said evolutionary biologist and study co-lead author Jonas Lescroart of the University of Antwerp in Belgium. Tiger cats previously had been considered a single species, but genetic studies decades ago suggested the existence of multiple species. Referring to the new species, Mr. Lescroart said, “Our information at this moment is limited to the two live individuals that we examined, and a small number of camera-trap records.” One of the live cats is a 10-year-old male that now lives in Senda Verde Wildlife Sanctuary after being kept by a local family in their home. Observing the Bolivian cat drew interest because “its characteristics did not match the descriptions, most of them based on Brazilian cats,” Ms. Nogales-Ascarrunz said. “This made us wonder: what tiger cat do we actually have in Bolivia?” The team analysed DNA from 38 cats sampled across several South American countries, including eight museum specimens. The study found that tiger cats are in fact five genetically distinct species. “We never expected this Bolivian tiger cat to be a separate species, and no one had ever proposed it as a different animal, subspecies or otherwise,” Mr. Lescroart said. Genetic analysis suggested that the Tilcayo lineage separated from other tiger cats about 1.4 million years ago. “The more differences in their DNA, the longer the time that we estimate those lineages to have been physically separated,” Mr. Lescroart said, adding that such a gap is generally considered a species-level divide in cats. The research team also described a new tiger cat subspecies in Peru’s Yungas, naming it *Leopardus tigrinus antisyayo* after Antisyayo, the region of the old Inca Empire that included the area it inhabits. The International Union for Conservation of Nature, or IUCN, Red List tracking the status of species currently treats tiger cats as two “vulnerable” species with declining populations.

THE SCIENCE QUIZ

Vivid displays in the wild

Vasudevan Mukunth

QUESTION 1
The X is the only mammal covered in true scales, which are made of keratin — the same material in your fingernails. Other such mammals are mainly covered in hair or fur; some also have quills and spikes. Name X, which also curls into a ball when threatened, turning its overlapping scales into a tough shield.
QUESTION #2
The fur of sloths often has a greenish tinge because it hosts _____, with the tinge allowing these arboreal animals to blend in with the canopy as camouflage. In addition, sloth hair also has grooves to trap moisture and which support a small ecosystem of moths and beetles. Fill in the blank.
QUESTION #3
Sometimes called the ‘stinkbird’, the

Y has a spiky crest. Y chicks also have wing claws that allow it to climb trees. And unlike most birds, the Y ferments leaves in its foregut, like a cow, in order to break down the organic matter and extract otherwise inaccessible nutrients. Name Y, which is the national bird of Guyana.
QUESTION #4
A close relative of seahorses, the _____ has elaborate, leaf-like appendages that make spotting the animal very difficult among seaweed. It also swims slowly using small, nearly transparent fins. The males carry fertilised eggs on the underside of their tails until the young hatch. Fill in the blanks.
QUESTION #5
Name the musk ox’s exceptionally soft, fine underwool that sheds naturally each spring. The material manages to insulate the ox against the Arctic cold, is warmer than sheep’s wool, and is thus highly prized for lightweight textiles.



Visual: Name this bird, whose males sport elaborate, lyre-shaped plumes for tail feathers. The bird is also famous for mimicking a variety of sounds, from the songs of other birds to chainsaws. FIR0002 (CC BY-NC)

Answers to September 17 quiz:

- Paradox over how much people are prepared to gamble – **Ans: St. Petersburg**
- Game involving stacking discs of various sizes on three towers – **Ans: Tower of Hanoi**
- Economist who used NYC to illustrate effect of shared expectations – **Ans: Thomas Schelling**
- Solid geometry problem involving cutting windows in a hemisphere – **Ans: Florentine**
- Birthplace of Apollo in Greek mythology – **Ans: Delos**

Visual: **Königsberg**

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For feedback and suggestions for ‘Science’, please write to science@thehindu.co.in with the subject ‘Daily page’

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Ethiopian armed groups announcing anti-govt. alliance

7 Seven Ethiopian armed groups said they have formed an alliance aimed at overthrowing Prime Minister Abiy Ahmed's government. The announcement of the Ethiopian Peoples' Forces Alliance for Survival brought together diverse groups ranging from Tigray in the north to the Somali Region in the south. REUTERS

Number of vehicles fined for illegal parking in Keralam

32,385 The Traffic and Road Safety Management wing of Keralam Police has collected ₹1.08 crore in fines from 32,385 vehicles for traffic violations, mainly illegal parking, during a Statewide seven-day inspection, police said. PTI

Number of vacancies in J&K government departments

40,672 In reply to questions from MLAs Sajad Lone and Irfan Hafeez Lone about recruitment and vacancies, the government said there were 40,672 vacancies across various government departments. PTI

Predicted decline in Maharashtra's sugar production

20 in per cent. Sugar production in Maharashtra may fall by nearly 20% in the upcoming crushing season, according to the West India Sugar Mills Association (WISMA). It said Maharashtra has faced a severe rain shortfall this year that adversely affected various crop yields. PTI

Amount of fine on Google by the EU for data location breach

403 in € million. Ireland's data protection watchdog, acting on behalf of the European Union, said on Monday that it had fined Google €403 million (\$462 million) for improperly using users' location data. AFP
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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Why did the SC reject methanol rules?

What did the Supreme Court find wrong with Maharashtra's methanol rules? Why did the court hold the methanol restrictions disproportionate? What constitutional rights did the impugned rules violate? What guidelines did the Supreme Court issue to prevent tragedies?

EXPLAINER

Rizmi Lia M.

The story so far:

In September 18, the Supreme Court struck down Maharashtra government rules requiring methanol to be denatured with a colourant and bitterant before sale to non-drug manufacturers, holding that the measures were disproportionate and lacked sufficient connection with the problem they sought to address. A Bench, including J.B. Pardiwala and K. Vinod Chandran, allowed the writ petitions filed by the methanol-based product manufacturers against the mandatory inclusion of additives in methanol because of amendments to the Maharashtra Poisons Rules, 1972.

What was the case about?

Methanol, or methyl alcohol, is a highly toxic substance. It is also widely used as an industrial raw material in products including formaldehyde, paraformaldehyde, paints, resins and other chemicals.

The Maharashtra government introduced stricter controls on methanol following a 1991 hooch tragedy in Mumbai, in which around 93 people died after consuming spurious liquor containing methanol. A committee headed by then Additional Director General of Police P.R. Parthasarthy was constituted to examine the causes of the tragedy and suggest measures.

In 2011, Maharashtra amended its Poisons Rules and introduced Rules 18A and 18B.

The petitioners are aggrieved by the operation of the impugned Rules 18A and 18B of the Maharashtra Poisons Rules, respectively, which restrict the purchase of methanol and mandate the addition of bitterant and colourant to methanol before sale to a non-drug manufacturer. Further, by operation of Rule 18B, any possession of methanol without a licence in Form A is liable to confiscation.

Companies told the court that colour contamination could make products



GETTY IMAGES

unacceptable to the paint and pharmaceutical industries, while the additives could affect catalysts, laboratory and pharmaceutical applications.

The State, however, argued that the rules were necessary because methanol could be mixed with liquor and cause fatal poisoning. Making methanol identifiable and bitter would help prevent its misuse, it added.

What did the court examine?

The central question was whether Rules 18A and 18B violated Articles 14 and 19(1)(g) of the Constitution.

The basic tenet of Article 14 is fairness in action and non-arbitrariness, while Article 19(1)(g) protects the right to carry on an occupation, trade or business. The court said that the State does have the power to regulate methanol. The Poisons Act, 1919 permits State governments to make rules regulating the possession and sale of poisons. But the question before the court was whether Rules 18A and 18B, respectively, of the Maharashtra Poisons Rules could be said to be arbitrary, disproportionate, and unreasonable.

What was the ruling?

The Supreme Court held that the impugned provisions of the Maharashtra Poisons Rules, 1972, were unconstitutional.

The court found that Rule 18A(1), which

required verification of a purchaser's Form A licence before methanol could be sold, imposed a disproportionate restriction on legitimate industrial users. The court held that merely verifying a Form A licence did not establish how the purchaser would use methanol.

The court also struck down Rule 18A(2), which required methanol sold to non-drug manufacturers to be mixed with a colourant and bitterant. It held that the requirement did not have a reasonable and proximate nexus with preventing the misuse of methanol in illicit liquor. The State failed to demonstrate that the additives would prevent diversion or manufacture of spurious liquor.

"What is discernable from the above is that in practicality, the impugned rules prescribe a regulatory framework that does not prevent the misuse of methanol in liquor which takes place in the unregulated field. The sub-rule even in the best case of full compliance cannot prevent the misuse it aims to prevent... It addresses a mischief, it does not in fact remedy while imposing a continuous burden on the industries," it observed.

As for Rule 18B, which provided for confiscation of methanol possessed without a Form A licence, the court found that it could conflict with the lawful possession of methanol under a Form B permit and effectively render that permit redundant. The provision, therefore, also

failed the proportionality test.

Applying the proportionality framework laid down in *K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India* (2017), the court held that although the prevention of loss of life from methanol-adulterated liquor constituted a legitimate aim, the impugned restrictions were neither suitable nor necessary to achieve that objective. The court consequently allowed the writ petitions, disposed of the connected civil appeal, and held that the impugned rules were violative of Articles 14 and 19(1)(g). The court noted that "a policy that is irrational, or lacks rational justification, or is violative of any constitutional, statutory or any other provision of law is liable to be struck down".

What were the guidelines?

The court passed the guidelines regarding important aspects and steps to prevent hooch tragedies and for effective implementation of the policies.

The court said States should work together through the prohibition, excise, police, transport, industries and health departments, along with NGOs, to prevent illegal liquor. This includes checking State borders, stopping illegal transport, identifying places where illicit liquor is made or stored, and monitoring industrial units that may illegally supply chemicals used to make spurious liquor.

As regards the existing rules in States/Union Territories, the court said methanol rules should be strengthened. Licences should be granted only after proper verification and should be regularly reviewed. Industrial users should return unused or excess methanol, maintain proper stock and consumption records, and face suspension or cancellation of licences for violations. Methanol should be transported in dedicated tankers under excise supervision and sealed in a way that prevents theft, diversion or tampering.

It also called for more de-addiction centres, support for affected families and local counselling centres.

The court added that while it could issue directions, effective implementation ultimately depends on the police and enforcement machinery.

THE GIST

▼ The Supreme Court struck down Maharashtra's rules requiring methanol sold to non-drug manufacturers to be denatured with colourant and bitterant, finding them disproportionate and unconstitutional under Articles 14 and 19(1)(g)

▼ It held that the rules did not have a reasonable and proximate nexus with preventing methanol misuse in illicit liquor, while imposing continuing burdens on legitimate industries

▼ The court issued guidelines for States to strengthen methanol regulation, including stricter licensing, stock and transport controls, and inter-departmental enforcement

How will Gaganyaan's crew module deploy its parachutes?

Why does Gaganyaan need multiple parachutes? How are they tested?

Unnikrishnan Nair S.

The story so far:

Any spacecraft entering the earth's atmosphere will rely primarily on atmospheric drag to lose a significant fraction of its velocity. To gently touch down on land or in the sea, additional decelerating systems like parachutes have to be activated.

The parachute used for crewed space vehicles demands extraordinary engineering with multi-staging, redundancy, high-performance materials and high-pressure packing to reduce storage space.

How are parachutes deployed?

The parachute system contains three types of chutes: pilot, drogue, and main. The pilot chute is a mini-parachute

deployed to pull out wider drogue or main chutes. The drogue chute is deployed early in the descent to stabilise the module and first reduce the velocity. The main chute has a wider canopy and is used in the final phase to reduce the velocity enough to achieve gentle soft-landing conditions.

The crew module's blunt shape creates a turbulent wake in its rear side and the parachute has to be ejected through this wake. The ejection mechanism should ensure the energy imparted to the parachute suffices to cross the wake in the shortest time and deploy the parachute in the far-wake region.

Generally, the parachutes are deployed when the module has reduced its speed to below the speed of sound.

Why deploy parachutes in stages?

As it descends, the Gaganyaan crew

module will be moving at around 170 m/s in the lower atmosphere. If the full-sized main parachute is deployed straightaway, it will experience a high opening shock, shredding the fabric or subjecting the crew to dangerously high deceleration.

Multi-staging, on the other hand, increases the chutes' diameter in successive stages, keeping the dynamic pressure to acceptable levels.

Also, to keep a chute from opening really quickly, a cord wound around the canopy restricts how far it can spread. After a preset delay, when the vehicle has slowed enough, a timed cutter severs the cord, which goes loose and allows the parachute to bloom fully.

How are parachutes tested?

There are different platforms to test parachutes. The 'rail track rocket sled' is a ground facility where a sled is accelerated

along rails by firing small solid motors, and the parachutes are deployed from the sled at an appropriate velocity. The Terminal Ballistic Research Lab, Chandigarh, has a state-of-the-art RTRS facility.

Other modes of testing include dropping the test article from a helicopter or an aircraft or using small rocket-powered test vehicles, which launch the crew module to some appropriate altitude and release it from there.

After splashdown in the sea or upon soft-landing on land, if the parachute is not detached immediately, the wind acting on the canopy could drag the module on land or capsize it in sea and this might cause injuries to the astronauts. Hence, the parachute is released by activating pyro cutters or mechanical quick-release devices.

What materials are used in aerospace parachutes?

A parachute's material is controlled by conditions like tensile strength, thermal resistance, and mass. Modern aerospace parachutes use advanced synthetic polymers engineered to meet specific design conditions.

Kevlar is used in high-load suspension lines, risers, and structural reinforcement tapes due to its exceptional tensile

strength and heat resistance. Nomex finds application in heat-exposed areas to withstand hot mortar gas discharge and aerothermal heating.

Nylon is widely used for canopy broadcloths because of its elasticity, which helps absorb initial dynamic shock loads during inflation. It is highly compressible, so it can be packed into a relatively small volume.

What parachutes are in the Gaganyaan crew module?

In crewed missions, recovery systems use redundant clusters of pilot, drogue, and main parachutes. The Gaganyaan crew module has two drogue chutes deployed by mortars and three main chutes deployed by mortar-ejected pilot chutes.

If one main parachute suffers an anomaly, the remaining two independent chains are fully capable of ensuring a safe touchdown.

ADRDE in Agra, which is a laboratory under the Defence Research & Development Organisation, is the developing agency.

(Unnikrishnan Nair S. is former director, VSSC and IIST; Founding Director, HSFC; and an expert in launch vehicle systems, orbital re-entry and human spaceflight technologies. Currently Dr Sarabhay Professor at VSSC)

Arora-Kukreja Ritika, 'Hindutva by Other Means: The Educational Market and the Politics of Demand', *Economic and Political Weekly*, Vol 61 Issue No. 34, August 22, 2026

September 22 marks the 40th anniversary of the second tied Test match in the history of cricket. How much do you remember about this historic India-Australia Test?

S CH-CHE